ASHTA SIDDHI · THE ART OF INNER MASTERY

THE EIGHT INNER POWERS

□□□□ · □□□□ · □□□□ · □□□□ · □□□□□□□□ · □□□□□□□□□ · □□□□□□ · □□□□□□

How Hanuman's Eight Powers Become Eight Daily Disciplines, and the Eleven Trading Paradoxes That Quietly Rob the Trader's Mind

NerdyIntruder

Nerdy Trading Way

A book of psychology. No strategies inside.

The Eight Inner Powers: Ashta Siddhi and the Eleven Trading Paradoxes

Copyright © NerdyIntruder. All rights reserved.

No part of this book may be reproduced without written permission from the author, except for brief quotations in reviews.

This book is a work of psychology and personal development. It contains no trading strategies and no investment recommendations, and nothing in it is financial advice. Trading in equities, derivatives and crypto assets carries a substantial risk of loss. Characters in the short stories are composites and fictional.

For every trader who has stared at a screen,

felt the wrong thing, and stayed to learn.

CONTENTS

The Map of the Book

Foreword 6
A Note Before You Begin 8
Preface: The Man Who Held the Sun in His Hand 10

Part One — The Foundation 12
1. What This Book Is Actually About 13
2. Where the Eight Powers Come From 17
3. How to Read a Miracle: Outer Power vs Inner Power 21

Part Two — The Eight Powers 26
4. Anima: The Power of Becoming Small 27
5. Mahima: The Power of Becoming Vast 31
6. Garima: The Power of Becoming Heavy 35
7. Laghima: The Power of Becoming Light 39
8. Prapti: The Power of Reaching 43
9. Prakamya: The Power of Free Will and Imagination 47
10. Ishitva: The Power of Command over Forces 51
11. Vashitva: The Power of Self-Governance 55

Part Three — The Eleven Trading Paradoxes 59
12. Why the Market Is the Perfect Mirror 60
13. Paradox One: Harry Hindsight 63
14. Paradox Two: The Winner's Curse 67
15. Paradox Three: The Employee Mindset 71
16. Paradox Four: FOMO 75
17. Paradox Five: The Screen Time Paradox 78
18. Paradox Six: The Emotional Entry 82

19. Paradox Seven: The Tortoise and the Hare 86
20. Paradox Eight: The Clutter Curse 90
21. Paradox Nine: Scaling by Volume 93
22. Paradox Ten: The Boredom Tax 97
23. Paradox Eleven: The Dollar Sign Delusion (in Rupees) 100

Part Four — The Closing Verse and the Daily Life 104

24. "Ashta Siddhi Nav Nidhi Ke Daata": The Gift Is Already Inside You 105
25. Building the Daily Practice: A Year in Eight Seasons 108
26. The Traps: How Each Power Turns Into Its Shadow 111
27. The Eight as One: Hanuman as a Complete Human Being 114

Closing Pages: A Reader's Review Sheet 117

FOREWORD

Foreword

A word from the author

Anyone who has sat in front of a trading screen knows a strange fact: the hardest part of the work is never on the screen. It is in the chest, in the stomach, in the hands that hover over a button, in the voice that whispers *just one more*. The chart is cold. The person looking at the chart is not.

I trade Indian equity and derivatives, and I also trade global crypto options. I write code, and I write about the psychology of trading under the name NerdyIntruder. Across all of those worlds I have noticed one thing repeating itself so often that I stopped calling it a coincidence: the mistakes that cost traders the most are not mistakes of knowledge. They are mistakes of *state*. A person who knows exactly what to do, and does something else, has not failed at information. He has failed at governing himself.

That is why this book began where it did. A short series of eight images, each paired with one Telugu word and one line of description, showed the *Ashta Siddhi*: the eight classical powers of Hanuman. A figure becomes as small as an atom. A body grows as large as a mountain. A man stands on a falling leaf. A calm figure sits among a lion, an elephant, a cobra and a bull. I looked at those eight pictures and saw something that no trading textbook had ever given me: a complete map of the inner skills a human being needs, drawn long before anyone had invented a stock exchange.

So I did two things. First, I walked through each of the eight powers slowly and translated every one from a miracle into a

daily discipline. Second, I paired that map with eleven **paradoxes of trading**: eleven places where the market quietly punishes the untrained mind. Harry Hindsight, who always knew it would happen. The Winner's Curse, who is cursed by his own victory. The Employee Mindset, who clocks in to a business that owes him no salary. FOMO, the Screen Time Paradox, the Emotional Entry, the Tortoise and the Hare, the Clutter Curse, Scaling by Volume, the Boredom Tax, and the Dollar Sign Delusion, which I have written here in Indian rupees, because the rupee is the currency in which most of my readers feel their wins and their losses.

You will notice that this is not a book of strategies. There is not one setup, one indicator, one entry or one exit in these pages. That is deliberate. Strategies are the cheapest part of trading; you can borrow ten of them by lunchtime. What you cannot borrow is the person who will execute them on a bad Thursday with a losing streak behind him. This book is about building that person.

> **A PROMISE AND A WARNING**
>
> The promise: if you practise even the smallest daily rep in each chapter, your behaviour in the market will change, and it will change in your life too, because the same eight muscles run both.
>
> The warning: nothing here is financial advice. Trading carries real risk of loss, and no book, including this one, changes that. Treat every idea in these pages as a mental training exercise, not a recommendation to buy or sell anything.

Read slowly. Mark the pages. Do the small exercises. And when a chapter makes you uncomfortable, stay with it a little longer than you want to: that discomfort is usually the exact spot where the work lies.

With respect, and with a student's humility,

NerdyIntruder

A NOTE BEFORE YOU BEGIN

A Note Before You Begin

Eight images, eight words, one question

This book began with eight images and eight Telugu words: □□□□, □□□□, □□□□, □□□□, □□□□□□□□, □□□□□□□□□□, □□□□□□□, □□□□□□. Each was paired with a single line that defined a supernatural power. A figure shrinks to the size of an atom. A body swells until its fingers look like mountains. A man stands on a falling leaf. Another sits calmly among a lion, an elephant, a cobra and a bull. They are beautiful images, and they raise a question that most people never stop to ask: *what are these stories for?*

If the eight siddhis were only about magic, they would be entertainment. This book takes a different position. The ancient teachers who preserved these eight powers were not trying to tell us that a human being can literally become the size of an atom. They were encoding, in the language of story, eight capacities of a fully developed mind: the ability to become small when smallness is wise, large when largeness is needed, heavy when stability is required, light when freedom is required, to reach what is far, to imagine freely, to command one's inner forces, and to bring one's whole self under one's own governance.

How the Book Is Built

Every power chapter in Part Two follows the same shape, so you always know where you are: **the story** behind the power, **the main idea**, **an analogy** to make the idea physical, **the quotes and texts** that stand behind it, **how to acquire it**, **how to**

internalize it into a daily routine, **a short mirror for the trader's mind**, **the common ways it goes wrong**, and finally **the main stressing points** so you can review the chapter in two minutes.

Part Three, the eleven paradoxes, follows a close cousin of that shape: a short story, the paradox stated plainly, its main idea, analogies, supporting texts, the siddhis that cure it, how to practise the cure, a daily routine, how the cure goes wrong, and the stressing points. Every paradox is tied back to one or two of the eight powers, so that by the end the two halves of the book become one system.

How to Read It

- **Slowly.** One chapter every two or three days is a good pace. The sages did not speak of eight shortcuts; they spoke of eight lifetimes of attention.
- **With a notebook.** Each chapter ends with a daily rep. Write the rep down and tick it off.
- **Out of order, if you must.** If a paradox is hurting you right now, jump to it, then return to the power that cures it.
- **Without perfectionism.** You are not trying to finish the book. You are trying to be slightly different on Tuesday than you were on Monday.

PREFACE

The Man Who Held the Sun in His Hand

The story every Indian child hears

There is a story every Indian child hears about a very young Hanuman. He looks into the morning sky, sees the sun glowing red and orange, and mistakes it for a ripe fruit. He leaps. He flies. The story says he reaches it.

Children love the story because it is funny. Adults forget it because it is impossible. But look at the structure of the story as if you were a student of the mind and not a student of astronomy. It contains four things: an **appetite** (he wants something), a **belief** (he thinks he can have it), a **leap** (he acts without hesitation) and a **consequence** (he is stopped, humbled, and then taught). That is a complete cycle of ambition, and it is the cycle each of us runs every day, whether we are chasing a promotion, a relationship, a skill or a profit.

The later Hanuman, the one who serves Rama, is the same being after discipline. He does not lose the power to leap. He gains the power to choose *when*, *how far*, *how big*, *how small* and *for whom*. The eight siddhis are the grammar of that discipline. They describe a person who can adjust his own size, weight, reach and will to match what the moment requires, and who is never the prisoner of any one setting.

Hold on to that image: **adjustability**. Most of us live with a few fixed settings. Some people are always big: loud, confident, expanding, taking up all the room. Others are always small: apologetic, hidden, afraid. Some are always heavy with worry

and responsibility. Others are always light and cannot commit to anything. The siddhis say that mastery is not choosing one setting and living there. Mastery is having the full dial and a steady hand.

> *"Ashta siddhi nav nidhi ke daata, as bar deen Janaki mata."*
>
> — Hanuman Chalisa, verse 31, attributed to Tulsidas

The verse says that Mother Janaki (Sita) granted Hanuman the boon of being the giver of the eight siddhis and the nine treasures. Notice that the verse does not say he earned them by force. It says they were *given*, and that he became a *giver*. Whatever else you take from this book, take this: power in this tradition is received through service and humility, and is meant to be passed on.

Notice also how closely the childhood leap resembles the behaviour of a young trader. The appetite is the dream of profit. The belief is the conviction that this time is different. The leap is the oversized position. The consequence is the market. Every trader meets the sun on the way up and is humbled by it. The question is whether he turns the humbling into discipline, as Hanuman did, or into bitterness.

PART ONE

The Foundation

Before the eight powers, a way of reading them

CHAPTER 1

What This Book Is Actually About

Eight capacities, one muscle

The Main Idea

This book is about eight trainable capacities of the human mind, taught through the figure of Hanuman, and about how to move each one from an idea in your head to a habit in your day. If you remember only one sentence, remember this one: **the eight siddhis are not eight ways to escape reality; they are eight ways to meet it fully.**

A person who can shrink (Anima) can listen, can notice small things, can serve, can drop the ego and slip through narrow places. A person who can expand (Mahima) can see the big picture, can carry large responsibilities, can speak and act at the scale the moment demands. A person who can become heavy (Garima) cannot be pushed around by noise, rumours or fear. A person who can become light (Laghima) can let go, forgive, travel, begin again. A person who can reach (Prapti) can connect, access, learn and obtain what is rightly theirs. A person who can imagine and will freely (Prakamya) can live by chosen purpose and not by habit. A person who commands forces (Ishitva) can steer fear, anger, greed and excitement instead of being steered by them. And a person who can govern themselves (Vashitva) holds the keys to all the other rooms.

The Question Behind the Question

Why would a book on trading and life begin with a god? Because psychology, in every era, has borrowed its best models from stories. Before there were diagrams of the brain there were

epics. The epic gave a human being a picture to hold onto, and a picture is easier to practise than an abstraction. If I tell you "regulate your emotional arousal," you nod and forget. If I show you a being who sits calmly while a lion, an elephant and a serpent crowd around him, you remember. You also begin, quietly, to ask what the lion, the elephant and the serpent are in your own life.

Analogy One: The Cockpit

Think of a modern aircraft cockpit. There are many instruments, and a poor pilot stares at only one of them: say, altitude. A good pilot scans them all in a rhythm: speed, altitude, heading, fuel, engine temperature, weather. Each instrument monitors one dimension of the flight, and a failure to watch any one of them can bring the plane down. The eight siddhis are the eight instruments of the human cockpit:

Siddhi	The question it asks	The gauge
Anima	How small am I willing to be right now?	Ego gauge
Mahima	How large is my vision and responsibility?	Altitude gauge
Garima	How steady and grounded am I?	Stability gauge
Laghima	How lightly am I holding things?	Weight gauge
Prapti	How far can I reach, and what can I access?	Range gauge
Prakamya	How freely and clearly can I choose and imagine?	Heading gauge
Ishitva	How well am I commanding my inner weather?	Storm gauge
Vashitva	Who is actually flying this aircraft?	Autopilot gauge

Most people over-watch one or two instruments and ignore the rest. This book trains you to scan all eight.

Analogy Two: The Key Ring

Imagine a ring of eight keys. Each key opens a different door in your house: the door of humility, the door of vision, the door of steadiness, the door of freedom, the door of access, the door of choice, the door of emotional command, and the door of self-rule. Most of us carry only two or three keys and wonder why entire rooms of our lives are locked. The chapters ahead hand you the remaining keys and show you which lock each fits.

What the Book Is Not

It is not a manual for supernatural abilities. It does not claim that meditation will let you fly. It is also not a religious sermon. You do not have to be Hindu, devout, or even spiritual to use it. The stories come from one tradition; the capacities belong to every human mind. A Stoic, a Christian, a Muslim, a Buddhist, an atheist who loves psychology: each can read the same chapters and find a usable practice.

It is also not a trading manual. There are no entries, exits, indicators or position sizes here. Where the trader's mind appears, it appears as a mirror, because the market is one of the fastest teachers of how well you have trained these eight capacities. Your reaction to a loss will tell you more about Garima and Ishitva than any book can.

The Three Promises of This Book

1. **A complete picture.** You will understand each siddhi: its name, its story, its meaning, its source texts.

2. **A usable translation.** You will learn to convert each power from myth to mental skill, and each trading paradox into a diagnosis with a cure.
3. **A daily practice.** You will leave each chapter with something small enough to do tomorrow morning.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 1

- The siddhis are best read as eight capacities of mastery, not eight tricks.
- The central idea is adjustability: changing your size, weight, reach and will to fit the moment.
- Power in this tradition is received through service and humility and is meant to be given onward.
- Each chapter moves from story to meaning to practice.
- This is a book about inner life; the trader's mind appears only as a mirror, and there are no strategies inside.

CHAPTER 2

Where the Eight Powers Come From

Three streams, one river

The Main Idea

The eight siddhis are not an invention of one author or one scripture. They are a theme that runs through several streams of Indian thought, and understanding those streams protects you from two common mistakes: believing the powers are mere fantasy, and believing they are a shortcut.

Stream One: The Yoga Tradition

The oldest systematic home of the siddhis is the yogic tradition. In the Yoga Sutras of Patanjali, an entire chapter, the Vibhuti Pada, is devoted to the "powers" that arise as a practitioner's concentration deepens. The sutras describe how, from mastery over the elements, there arises the ability to become minute and the other perfections, along with the perfection of the body (Yoga Sutra 3.45 is the passage usually cited).

But the same text contains a warning that every student of the siddhis must carry. In sutra 3.37, Patanjali observes that these powers are obstacles to deep absorption, even if they appear as accomplishments to the worldly mind. In plain language: the powers are signs of progress and, at the same time, temptations that can end the progress. A person who becomes proud of the power has already lost the discipline that produced it. This is the first great teaching about the siddhis, and it will return again and again: **the capacity is a gift; the attachment to the capacity is the trap.**

Stream Two: The Epic Tradition

In the Ramayana, Hanuman does not announce his powers. They are revealed when needed. When the search party stands on the shore with the ocean ahead and no one knows who can cross, the elder Jambavan reminds Hanuman of what he already is. Hanuman had forgotten his own capacity, because of a childhood curse that veiled his memory of it.

Pause on that detail, because it is the secret structure of the whole book. The power was not absent. It was *forgotten*. And the teacher's role was not to give the power but to remind. The Sundara Kanda, the "beautiful book" of the Ramayana, is where Hanuman uses almost every siddhi in a single journey:

- He expands to cross the ocean (Mahima).
- He shrinks to slip past the sea-monster Surasa's mouth and escape (Anima).
- He becomes tiny to enter Lanka unseen at night (Anima, Laghima).
- He travels across the sea and through the sky (Prapti).
- He takes forms suited to each situation (Prakamya).
- He sets Lanka ablaze with his burning tail and walks away unharmed (Ishitva).
- He walks among the sleeping women of Ravana's palace, then examines his own mind and finds it undisturbed (Vashitva).

Stream Three: The Devotional Tradition

By the time of Tulsidas's Hanuman Chalisa, the siddhis have been gathered into a prayer, and the prayer has become a daily companion for millions. Three verses matter for our purposes. **Verse 9** praises the way Hanuman assumed a subtle, tiny form to

show himself to Sita, and a terrifying form to burn Lanka: Anima and Mahima, the two ends of the size dial, in one breath. **Verse 18** recalls the leap toward the sun, the "sweet fruit" of the childhood story: a symbol of reach and of the courage to attempt what looks impossible. **Verse 31** is the verse already quoted: Hanuman as giver of the eight siddhis and nine treasures.

Hanuman is also described in a well-known invocation as *jitendriya*, "one who has conquered the senses," and *buddhimatam varishtham*, "foremost among the wise." Notice that the two titles go together. Mastery of the senses and excellence of intelligence are presented as a single package. You cannot have one without the other.

Analogy: The River With Three Tributaries

The teaching of the siddhis is like a river fed by three streams. The yoga stream supplies the **method** (concentration, discipline, the warning against pride). The epic stream supplies the **story** (Hanuman's actions as living examples). The devotional stream supplies the **emotional fuel** (surrender, love, service). A reader who drinks from only one stream gets a partial understanding. Method without story is dry. Story without method is entertainment. Both without devotion are arrogance.

Why the Origin Matters to a Modern Reader

Knowing the origin helps you resist two temptations. The first is cynicism: "this is all myth, so it is useless." But the myth carries a precise psychology that works whether or not you believe in the metaphysics. The second is fantasy: "if I just chant the right thing, I will acquire powers." The tradition itself warns against this. The siddhis arrive as a by-product of discipline and service, and the disciplined person treats them lightly. A trader who hopes to *buy*

discipline in a course, a tool or a secret will be sold exactly what he hopes for, and will remain exactly as he was.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 2

- The siddhis appear in the yoga, epic and devotional traditions, each adding a different ingredient: method, story, emotional fuel.
- Patanjali's warning: the powers can be obstacles if the practitioner becomes attached to them.
- Hanuman's powers were forgotten, not absent; the teacher's role is to remind.
- The Sundara Kanda shows the siddhis working together in one mission.
- Jitendriya and buddhimatam varishtham: self-mastery and wisdom travel together.

CHAPTER 3

How to Read a Miracle

Outer power versus inner power

The Main Idea

To use these stories, you need a method for translating a miracle into a skill. This chapter gives you that method. It is the most important chapter in the book, because without it the other chapters are just beautiful pictures.

The Three-Layer Reading

Every siddhi can be read at three layers, and a mature reader holds all three at once.

Layer 1: the literal layer. This is the story as it is told. Hanuman literally grows as large as a mountain. A reader may believe this or not. The book does not demand either response.

Layer 2: the symbolic layer. This is what the story says about the human condition. Growing large is the human ability to take up a bigger frame of vision. Becoming tiny is the human ability to lower the ego until you fit through narrow openings.

Layer 3: the practical layer. This is the daily behaviour that trains the capacity. If Anima is the ability to shrink the ego, the practical layer might be: in every conversation today, speak last in one meeting and ask one honest question.

Think of the three layers like a seed, a tree and a fruit. The literal story is the seed: compact and ancient. The symbolic meaning is the tree: it grows from the seed and gives shade. The practical habit is the fruit: it is what you actually eat.

Analogy: The Compressed File

A story is a compressed file. Ancient teachers could not store large volumes of psychology in writing, so they compressed them into images and events. Your job as a reader is to unzip the file. The miracle is the zipped form; the lesson is the unzipped form. If you try to read the zipped file as it is, you see unreadable symbols. Once unzipped, it becomes a useful document. The tiny figure walking through giant fibres is a compressed file for "fine attention to small things." The crater in cracked stone is a compressed file for "the weight of a settled character." The leaf is a compressed file for "how lightly a free person can stand on a falling world."

Five Rules for Translating a Power

1. **Ask what problem the power solves.** Every power exists because a situation required it. Anima solved the problem of entering a guarded city. What is the equivalent guarded place in your life?
2. **Ask what the power costs.** Each power has a price in discipline. Laghima's price is non-attachment. Garima's price is patience.
3. **Ask what the power looks like when it is missing.** Anima missing looks like an inflated ego. Laghima missing looks like clinging.
4. **Ask what the shadow version looks like.** Every power has a counterfeit. Mahima's counterfeit is arrogance. Vashitva's counterfeit is manipulation.
5. **Ask for the smallest daily rep.** If you cannot do it in ten minutes, it is too large. Shrink the practice.

The Opposite-Pairs Principle

The eight siddhis come in natural pairs, and each pair balances itself:

Pair	What they balance
Anima and Mahima	Small and large
Garima and Laghima	Heavy and light
Prapti and Prakamya	Reaching and choosing: what you can obtain, and the freedom to want clearly
Ishitva and Vashitva	Command over forces and command over self: outward-facing and inward-facing governance

Think of the pairs as the four wheels of a vehicle. If the left front is large and the right front is small, you spin in circles. If you are too heavy without lightness, you become stubborn. If you are too light without weight, you become unreliable. A balanced life means each pair works in tandem.

The Master Skill Beneath All Eight

Beneath the eight lies one root skill: **attention that can be directed on purpose.** Anima is attention narrowed. Mahima is attention widened. Garima is attention held. Laghima is attention released. Prapti is attention extended. Prakamya is attention imagined. Ishitva is attention applied to emotion. Vashitva is attention turned on the attender. If this is true, then everything in this book is a training of one muscle in eight different ways. You are not learning eight alien skills; you are learning to use a single mental muscle in eight directions.

> *"You have power over your mind, not outside events. Realize this, and you will find strength."*
>
> — A saying widely attributed to Marcus Aurelius; consistent with the opening of Epictetus's Enchiridion, which divides things into what is up to us and what is not

The Stoic idea of the dichotomy of control and the yogic idea of the siddhis arrive at the same insight from two directions: the only territory a human being can truly govern is the inner territory, and governing it well changes everything outside. This makes the two traditions friendly neighbours, and later chapters will let them speak to one another.

A Practice to Begin With: The Eight-Line Evening Review

Before you begin Part Two, start a very small habit. Each evening, write one sentence for each of the eight instruments in the cockpit. You do not need to write well. A sample:

SAMPLE EVENING REVIEW

Anima: I interrupted my mother today; I will listen first tomorrow.

Mahima: I forgot why I am doing this work.

Garima: I stayed steady in the argument.

Laghima: I carried yesterday's irritation into today.

Prapti: I did not ask for help when I needed it.

Prakamya: I chose my evening instead of drifting.

Ishitva: Anger rose at 4 pm; I noticed it and waited.

Vashitva: I reached for my phone eleven times without deciding to.

This little review is a mirror, not a judge. After two weeks you will see which instrument you ignore. That instrument is where Part Two will help you most.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 3

- Read every siddhi in three layers: literal, symbolic, practical.
- A story is a compressed file; the reader's job is to unzip it.
- Use the five translation questions: problem, cost, absence, shadow, smallest rep.
- The eight come in four balancing pairs; mastery is balance, not extremes.
- Under all eight sits directed attention: one muscle trained in eight directions.
- Begin the eight-line evening review now; it is your baseline.

PART TWO

The Eight Powers

One chapter for each siddhi: story, meaning, practice

CHAPTER 4

Anima (□□□□): The Power of Becoming Small

The power that lets one change the body to the size of an atom

The Story

The first siddhi in the list is the smallest. When Hanuman reaches Lanka, he faces a city of walls, guards and a presiding spirit who will not let a monkey of his size enter. He does not fight his way in. He shrinks. In the stories he becomes as small as a cat, creeps along the ramparts at dusk and slips into the city unnoticed. Later he appears before Sita in a small, gentle form so that she is not frightened by his true size. The Chalisa honours this with a line about assuming a subtle form to reveal himself to Sita.

The image for Anima shows a tiny figure walking through enormous fibres of rope and a boulder of crystal. The camera is so close to the ground that the world looks like a landscape of giants. That is exactly the point: when you become small, the world reveals details that the large cannot see.

The Main Idea

Anima is the power of **voluntary smallness**. It is the capacity to lower the ego, narrow the attention and reduce your own footprint so that you can enter places that pride cannot enter. It is not weakness, because weakness is involuntary and Anima is chosen. A giant who cannot shrink is trapped by his own size; a person who can shrink when it is wise can pass through any door. There are four forms of smallness, and the siddhi covers all four:

1. **Smallness of ego:** the willingness to be the beginner, to say "I don't know," to be corrected.
2. **Smallness of attention:** the ability to focus on one fine detail without being distracted by the grand scheme.
3. **Smallness of footprint:** acting quietly, without announcement, without needing credit.
4. **Smallness of scale:** breaking a huge task into the smallest possible next step.

Analogy: The Needle and the Thread

Think of threading a needle. The thread is soft and wide; the eye of the needle is tiny. You cannot force the thread through. You must wet the end, twist the fibres together, narrow the tip, and then, steadily, guide it in. The thread that refuses to narrow stays outside. The eye of the needle is every opportunity that demands humility. The thread that can make itself fine passes through, and the whole cloth follows it.

Another image: a seed. A seed is the smallest form of a tree. It carries the entire future in a compact, quiet, humble package. Nobody admires a seed, and yet everything admirable begins as one. Anima is the willingness to be a seed for a while.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

The Greek-Roman Stoic Epictetus, a former slave, says in his Discourses that it is impossible for a person to learn what he thinks he already knows. That line is Anima in a sentence. An inflated mind has no room for new information. A shrunken ego has the whole room free.

The Tao Te Ching makes a similar observation in Chapter 7: the sage puts himself last and ends up in front. The paradox is not a trick. When you stop competing for the front, you stop wasting

energy defending it. And the Chalisa verse that describes Hanuman appearing to Sita in a subtle form reminds us that the greatest being in the story chose the gentlest appearance for the person who needed comfort. Great power expressed as great gentleness is the signature of Anima.

How to Acquire It

1. **Notice the size you are carrying.** Spend one day simply observing: in every interaction, how large did I make myself? Did I interrupt? Did I correct someone to look clever? Did I steer the conversation back to myself?
2. **Practise the beginner's mind on purpose.** Choose one domain in which you consider yourself competent and approach it as a beginner for a week. Read the basics again. Ask the "obvious" questions. You will find gaps you did not know existed.
3. **Shrink the task, not the ambition.** When a goal feels huge, ask: what is the smallest version of the next action? Not "write the chapter" but "write one honest sentence." Anima turns a mountain into a first step.
4. **Do one thing anonymously each day.** One act of help, one cleanup, one kind message, with no credit and no mention. This trains the ego to live without applause.

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Before the day starts, say silently: *Today, I will be teachable.*
- **During the day:** In one conversation, ask a question before offering an opinion. Make a habit of this one rep.
- **Evening:** Write down one thing you learned from someone you would normally overlook.

A useful rule of thumb: if you feel the need to look impressive, you have grown too large for the doorway. Shrink, and watch the door open.

> **THE TRADER'S MIRROR**
>
> The market has a way of enlarging a person's ego after a win and wounding it after a loss. A trader who has not practised Anima mistakes a good week for a personal victory and a bad week for a personal defeat. The practice of smallness says something different: *I am a small participant in a very large process.* That sentence is not defeat. It is relief. It frees you from the impossible job of being right about the future, and returns you to the possible job of behaving well in the present.

How It Goes Wrong

The shadow of Anima is **self-erasure**. A person who confuses smallness with worthlessness begins to hide, to avoid taking up any space and to refuse responsibility. Real Anima is chosen and temporary. Hanuman shrank for a purpose and then returned to his full stature. If you never return to full size, it is not Anima; it is fear wearing a humble costume.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 4

- Anima is voluntary smallness, not weakness.
- It has four forms: ego, attention, footprint, scale.
- The image to hold: thread through the eye of the needle; pride cannot pass, fineness can.
- Epictetus: you cannot learn what you think you already know.
- Daily rep: ask before telling; do one thing anonymously.
- The shadow is self-erasure; the cure is to return to full size when the moment ends.

CHAPTER 5

Mahima (□□□□): The Power of Becoming Vast

The power that lets one enlarge the body as heavy as a mountain and without limit

The Story

If Anima is the first power in the list, Mahima is its mirror. On the southern shore of India, the search party stands before a hundred-league ocean. The younger vanaras step back. Jambavan reminds Hanuman who he is. And the story says that Hanuman grew. His body swelled until the shore trembled and the mountains seemed small beneath his feet. Then he leapt.

The image for Mahima is one of the most striking in the set: giant fingers tower over a snow-covered range, while tiny climbers walk below. The scale is almost absurd. And yet the message is quiet: when the task is mountainous, the mind has to become mountainous.

The Main Idea

Mahima is the power of **voluntary expansion**. It is the capacity to grow your vision, your courage, your responsibility and your presence to the scale that a moment demands. If Anima is about fitting through a small door, Mahima is about not letting a large moment find you small. It, too, has four forms:

1. **Expansion of vision:** seeing the big picture and the long timeline.

2. **Expansion of courage:** acting at the size of the task, not at the size of your doubt.
3. **Expansion of responsibility:** carrying more than your own needs: family, team, community.
4. **Expansion of presence:** occupying a room with calm authority when the room needs it.

Analogy: The Zoom Lens

A photographer carries a lens that can go from tight macro to wide landscape. Neither setting is "the correct one." A macro shot of a dewdrop is beautiful and a wide shot of a valley is beautiful. A poor photographer is stuck on one lens. A master changes the lens to match the subject. Mahima is the wide lens of the mind. When you are caught in an irritating small moment (a delay, an insult, a setback), Mahima lets you pull the camera back until the moment becomes one small dot inside a very long film.

Another image: a mountain climber at base camp sees only the next slope. At the summit she sees the whole range. Mahima is the ability to climb mentally, even while your feet are still at base camp.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

The most dramatic expression of vastness in Indian literature is the Vishvarupa vision in Chapter 11 of the Bhagavad Gita, where Arjuna sees the entire cosmos contained in a single form. Arjuna's reaction is not pride but trembling. This is an important detail: a true expansion of vision *humbles*, it does not inflate. If your sense of vastness makes you feel superior, it was not Mahima; it was ego dressed up as perspective.

In the West, Marcus Aurelius practised what scholars call the "view from above" in his Meditations: imagining oneself looking

down at the earth, at cities, armies, farms, marriages and funerals, and noticing how small each individual drama is within the whole. He used it to deflate anxiety and to remember his proper place. It is Mahima as a daily meditation. The Chalisa's reference to the leap toward the sun suggests the daring of a mind that does not accept the limits of its first estimate. The child Hanuman was wrong about what the sun was, but right about what he was capable of attempting. The later Hanuman keeps the courage and corrects the knowledge.

How to Acquire It

1. **Practise the view from above.** Once a day, for two minutes, close your eyes and imagine rising above your house, your city, your country, the earth. Look back at the problem that is bothering you. How large is it now?
2. **Write a ten-year sentence.** One sentence: *In ten years, I want my life to look like this.* Return to it weekly. Vision does not expand by accident; it expands by being written down.
3. **Take on one responsibility slightly larger than comfortable.** Not reckless, but stretching: mentor a junior, lead a small project, organise a family event. Mahima grows by carrying.
4. **Study a bigger field than your own.** A trader studies philosophy. A teacher studies economics. An engineer studies poetry. Widening the input widens the mind.

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Read the ten-year sentence aloud.
- **During the day:** When irritated, ask: *Will this matter in a year? In ten?*

- **Evening:** Write one thing you did today that was larger than yourself: a kindness, an act of service, an act of courage.

> **THE TRADER'S MIRROR**
>
> A trader who lives inside a single day lives inside a single candle. He magnifies each tick as if it were destiny. Mahima, applied to the mind, is the habit of seeing each day as one frame in a long film. The lens that sees a career, not a day, is the lens that survives bad days.

How It Goes Wrong

The shadow of Mahima is **arrogance and overreach**. Expansion without Garima (weight and grounding) becomes bloat. The person who grows larger and larger without a solid core becomes fragile, easily punctured. Remember that Hanuman grew only for the leap and then returned to a size at which he could serve. Vastness is a tool, not an identity.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 5

- Mahima is voluntary expansion of vision, courage, responsibility and presence.
- Image to hold: the wide lens; the same problem looks different from a higher altitude.
- Gita 11 and Marcus Aurelius's view from above: real vastness humbles.
- Daily rep: the ten-year sentence and the view from above.
- The shadow is arrogance; the antidote is the next power, Garima.

CHAPTER 6

Garima (□□□□): The Power of Becoming Heavy

The power that lets one make the body so heavy that it cannot be imagined or moved

The Story

The most famous story of Garima is not in the Ramayana but in the Mahabharata. The mighty Bhima, strongest of the Pandavas, walks through a forest and finds an old monkey lying across the path with his tail stretched out. Bhima, proud of his strength, demands that the monkey move the tail aside. The monkey, old and tired, says: "I am too weak. You move it." Bhima tries to lift it with one hand. It does not move. He tries with both hands. It does not move. He strains with every muscle until sweat pours down his face. The tail stays exactly where it is. Humbled, Bhima folds his hands and asks who the monkey really is. It is Hanuman, his own elder brother in spirit, born of the same wind god.

The image for Garima shows a seated figure at the centre of a crater, the cracked stone bending inward around him, while an elephant stands at the rim. The lesson is in the geometry: the ground bends toward weight. Everything around a heavy being arranges itself around him.

The Main Idea

Garima is the power of **voluntary heaviness**. It is the capacity to become immovable: unshakeable in your values, steady under pressure, impossible to push around by noise, rumour, flattery or fear. If Mahima is about being larger, Garima is about being

denser. It is not about size but about *mass of character*. The four kinds of weight:

1. **Weight of values:** knowing what you will not do, whatever the price.
2. **Weight of word:** saying little, meaning it, and doing it.
3. **Weight of emotional composure:** staying still when others are agitated.
4. **Weight of routine:** a daily structure so settled that it carries you on days when willpower is low.

Analogy: The Anchor and the Keel

A ship at sea has two forms of heaviness. The anchor lets a ship stay in place when the wind is against it. The keel, the heavy beam beneath the hull, lets a sailing ship move forward even against the wind, because it resists being pushed sideways. Garima is both. Sometimes it holds you still when pressure comes; sometimes it allows you to keep your heading while the world pushes at your flank.

Another image: a banyan tree. Its roots go deep and wide, and when the storm arrives, the leaves shake while the trunk stays calm. Garima is the part of you that stays calm while the leaves shake.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

Marcus Aurelius, in his Meditations, writes that one should be like the headland against which the waves keep breaking: it stands firm and the water around it grows quiet. That is Garima in a paragraph. The Bhagavad Gita gives a precise psychological description. In Chapter 2, Krishna tells Arjuna that contacts with heat and cold, pleasure and pain come and go and are impermanent, and that he should bear them patiently. A few

verses later, the person of steady wisdom is described as one whose mind is not shaken by sorrow and who does not crave pleasures. This is weight as an inner quality, not a muscle.

The story of Bhima and Hanuman teaches a second point. Hanuman did not demonstrate Garima by striking Bhima. He demonstrated it by *being where he was*. True heaviness does not need to push; it only needs not to move.

How to Acquire It

1. **Write your three non-negotiables.** Three sentences beginning with *I will never…* These are the foundation stones. Everything else may bend; these do not.
2. **Slow the response.** Introduce a one-breath delay before you answer any provocation, in a message or in person. A heavy object has inertia; it does not accelerate instantly. This single pause builds inertia.
3. **Build a spine of routine.** A fixed wake time. A fixed first hour. A fixed closing ritual. Routine is stored willpower; it keeps the ship pointed on stormy days.
4. **Reduce your word count and raise your word weight.** Make fewer promises and keep all of them. Each kept promise adds mass; each broken one removes it.

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Read your three non-negotiables aloud.
- **During the day:** When someone is agitated, match their pace, not their pitch. Speak slower, lower and less.
- **Evening:** Ask: *Where did I move when I should have stayed? Where did I stay when I should have moved?*

> **THE TRADER'S MIRROR**
>
> The moment of a sharp loss, or a sharp gain, is a test of mass. A light mind jumps: it revenge-chases, it celebrates and loosens, it abandons its own rules. A heavy mind lets the wave pass and stays where it is. Garima does not mean you feel nothing; it means the feeling does not move the furniture.

How It Goes Wrong

The shadow of Garima is **stubbornness**. A heavy person who cannot be moved even by good reasons becomes rigid and heavy in the wrong way. This is why Garima needs its partner, Laghima. Hanuman could be immovable and weightless. The wise person knows which one the moment calls for.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 6

- Garima is voluntary heaviness: mass of character.
- Story: Bhima cannot lift the tail; true heaviness does not need to push.
- Image to hold: anchor, keel and banyan.
- Marcus Aurelius's headland; Gita 2: bear the passing contacts of pleasure and pain.
- Daily rep: three non-negotiables and a one-breath delay.
- The shadow is stubbornness; its partner is Laghima.

CHAPTER 7

Laghima (□□□□): The Power of Becoming Light

The power of weightlessness: to stand on a falling leaf

The Story

When Hanuman crouched on Mount Mahendra to leap across the ocean, the story says the mountain sank under the force of his legs. Yet once he was in the air, he was so light that he skimmed above the waves with his shadow trailing on the water like a ship's sail. On the way, the golden peak Mainaka rose from the sea and offered him rest. Hanuman touched it with his hand in thanks, and flew on. He did not stay to be comforted. Elsewhere, in the same journey, the sea-demoness Simhika seized his *shadow* to drag him down, and the story is careful to note that it was his shadow, not his body, that was caught. What can hold you down is often only the weight you have let trail behind you.

The image for Laghima is a man standing calmly on a single falling leaf. The leaf is dropping through the air and he is perfectly balanced on it. The scene is almost comic, and then, quietly, profound: the world is falling and he is not afraid, because he is carrying nothing that falls faster than a leaf.

The Main Idea

Laghima is the power of **voluntary lightness**: the capacity to let go, to travel light, to forgive, to begin again, to hold things loosely enough that you can still move. It is the partner of Garima. Garima gives you roots; Laghima gives you wings. A person with

only roots becomes a statue. A person with only wings becomes a feather in someone else's wind. The four lightnesses:

1. **Lightness of possessions and obligations:** owning and committing to less, so that nothing owns you.
2. **Lightness of grudges and regrets:** forgiving yourself and others, so the past does not ride on your back.
3. **Lightness of outcome:** doing the work fully while holding the result loosely.
4. **Lightness of mood:** the ability to smile, to see the humour in a bad day, to refuse to make every moment a tragedy.

Analogy: The Hot-Air Balloon and the Ballast

A hot-air balloon rises when the pilot drops the sandbags. The balloon is not stronger after dropping them; it is simply no longer carrying what it never needed. Most of us fly with sandbags of every colour: yesterday's insult, last year's mistake, a promise made to impress someone we no longer know, a purchase we regret but cannot sell, a belief we hold only because we have always held it. Laghima is the pilot's calm hand reaching for the sandbag and saying: *this one can go.*

A second image: the raft in the Buddha's well-known parable. A traveller builds a raft to cross a river. Having crossed, he does not shoulder the raft and carry it through the forest, however grateful he is to it. Tools, beliefs and even past victories are rafts. Use them fully, then put them down.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

The opening verse of the Isha Upanishad contains one of the most compressed teachings of lightness in any language. Its famous phrase, often rendered as *enjoy through letting go*, says that the way to truly enjoy the world is not to clutch it. The

Bhagavad Gita (2.47) states the same idea as a discipline: you have a right to the action, never to its fruits. The mind that is not tied to the fruit moves lightly through the action.

Epictetus makes the Western parallel in the Enchiridion: do not demand that events happen as you wish; wish them to happen as they do, and you will go on well. That is lightness as philosophy: the willingness to travel with what is, rather than dragging a private version of what should have been.

How to Acquire It

1. **Do a ten-minute weekly release.** Once a week, remove one physical thing, one open loop and one resentment. Throw out the object, close the loop, write the resentment on paper and tear it up.
2. **Write an unsent letter.** Write a letter of forgiveness to someone, or to yourself, and do not send it. The goal is not communication; it is unloading.
3. **Practise the exhale.** When you notice your shoulders rising, breathe out slowly twice as long as you breathe in. The body teaches the mind that it is safe to release.
4. **Separate effort from result.** Before an important task, say: *My job is the next honest action. The result is not my department.*

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Ask: *What am I carrying today that I do not need?*
- **During the day:** When a mistake happens, say: *Done. Next.* Then take one breath.
- **Evening:** Name one thing from today you are putting down before you sleep.

> **THE TRADER'S MIRROR**
>
> The commonest sandbag in a trader's basket is yesterday's loss. A mind that carries it into today trades *against* the person who lost, not against the market in front of it. Laghima does not erase memory; it erases the grudge against the past. It lets you review a mistake as a teacher and not relive it as a punishment.

How It Goes Wrong

The shadow of Laghima is **flakiness**: the person who calls it "non-attachment" when he simply cannot commit, who drops every project at the first discomfort and mistakes drifting for freedom. A feather is light, but it is not free; it goes wherever the wind goes. Real lightness has roots beneath it. That is why Laghima must always be practised with Garima.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 7

- Laghima is voluntary lightness: letting go without losing yourself.
- It has four forms: possessions, grudges, outcomes, mood.
- Images to hold: the balloon and its ballast; the raft you leave on the bank.
- Isha Upanishad and Gita 2.47: enjoy through letting go; hold the fruit loosely.
- Daily rep: the weekly release, the exhale, and *Done. Next.*
- The shadow is flakiness; its partner is Garima.

CHAPTER 8

Prapti (□□□□□□□□): The Power of Reaching

The power to reach what is far and obtain what is rightly yours

The Story

The child Hanuman reached for the sun. The adult Hanuman reached for something harder: the one person in the world who had not yet been found. He crossed the ocean, searched an enemy city room by room, and finally reached Sita with Rama's ring, a small object carrying a message across an impossible distance. Later, when Lakshmana lay wounded and only a rare herb from a distant Himalayan peak could save him, Hanuman reached the mountain in a single night. Unable to identify the herb in the dark, he did what only a reaching mind with a humble heart would do: he lifted the whole mountain and brought it back.

That last detail is worth a pause. Reach without humility would have guessed at the herb. Reach *with* humility said: *I do not know which one it is, so I will bring the whole source and let the experts choose.* Prapti is not only the power of going far. It is the power of bringing back what is actually needed.

The Main Idea

Prapti is the power of **voluntary reach**: the capacity to access knowledge, people, resources and places that seem out of range, and to obtain what is rightfully, honestly yours. It is the opposite of grasping. A grasping hand closes on one thing and stays

closed. A reaching hand extends, receives, and opens again. The four reaches:

1. **Reach of knowledge:** the ability to find the teacher, the book, the answer.
2. **Reach of people:** the willingness to ask, to connect, to ask for help without shame.
3. **Reach of resources:** building the means (skills, savings, tools) to act on a plan.
4. **Reach of presence:** showing up, in person and on time, in the places where your life is decided.

Analogy: The Well and the Rope

Water lies deep in a well. Thirst alone does not bring it up. You need a rope long enough, a bucket that holds, and the patience to lower it, wait and pull. Prapti is the rope. Many people sit beside a well with a loud thirst and a short rope and conclude that wells are a myth. Others have a long rope and never lower it because they are afraid of the splash.

A second image: a fruit tree in a quiet orchard. Mangoes ripen without any announcement. The one who gets the fruit is not the loudest person in the orchard but the one who showed up, brought a ladder, and picked gently. The orchard is generous to those who reach respectfully.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

The Katha Upanishad (1.3.14) gives the most famous call to reach: *arise, awake, and having reached the excellent teachers, learn.* Notice the order: wake first, then reach, then learn. The Bhagavad Gita (9.22) offers a quiet promise to the steady devotee, often rendered as: *I carry what you lack, and I preserve*

what you have. Reach and security are two sides of one steadiness.

The Gospel line "ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened" (Matthew 7:7) teaches the same lesson in a different idiom: the door of reach opens from the side of the one who knocks. And in the Chalisa itself, the leap towards the sun (verse 18) is held up as a model of the impossible attempted with confidence, and then, in the very next verses, the ring placed in the mouth, the ocean crossed without wonder: reach is presented as ordinary for the trained mind.

How to Acquire It

1. **Make an "asks" list.** Write down three things you need that you have been too proud or shy to ask for: a mentor's time, a favour, feedback, an introduction. Make one ask a week.
2. **Find your teacher.** Identify one person, living or in a book, who is further along the path you want, and study that person with devotion for ninety days.
3. **Extend the range of your input.** Read one thing a week from a field that has nothing to do with your work. Reach is also the width of your curiosity.
4. **Build the rope before the thirst.** Learn the skill, save the amount, build the contact *before* you need it.

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Ask: *Who or what is one step beyond my current reach today?*
- **During the day:** Make one small ask: a question, a request for clarity, a message you have been delaying.

- **Evening:** Write down one thing you learned or received because you reached for it.

> **THE TRADER'S MIRROR**
>
> Reach and grasp look alike in a screen's blue light. The trader who reaches is building knowledge, community and capital slowly: reading, reviewing, asking. The trader who grasps is lunging at every moving price as if the world is about to close the door. Prapti says that what is truly yours cannot be missed, because you have been preparing the rope. Chapter 16, on FOMO, is the grasping hand's autobiography.

How It Goes Wrong

The shadow of Prapti is **greed**: reaching for what is not yours, or for more than you can hold, or for what you have not earned the capacity to carry. Hanuman's reaching always returned to service. Reaching that returns only to the self becomes hoarding. Its remedy is Laghima: the open hand that releases as readily as it receives.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 8

- Prapti is voluntary reach: knowledge, people, resources, presence.
- Story: the mountain brought whole; reach with humility.
- Image to hold: the well and the rope; build the rope before the thirst.
- Katha Upanishad: arise, awake, and reach the teachers.
- Daily rep: one ask a day, one stretch of input a week.
- The shadow is greed; its partner is Laghima.

CHAPTER 9

Prakamya (□□□□□□□□□): The Power of Free Will

The power of imagination, free choice and the freedom to want clearly

The Story

When Hanuman first meets Rama and Lakshmana in the forest, he does not approach as a monkey. He appears as a humble ascetic, speaks with such grace and clarity that Rama remarks on the refinement of his speech, and only later reveals himself. In Lanka he becomes a cat-sized shadow; before Sita he takes a gentle form; before Ravana he takes a fearless one. In every case he is not *forced* into a shape. He chooses the form that serves the moment.

That is Prakamya: the freedom to choose, imagine and become, without being dragged by habit or by other people's expectations. If Anima and Mahima are the size dial, Prakamya is the *form* dial: the power to be a different person in a different moment, while remaining fundamentally yourself.

The Main Idea

Prakamya is the power of **voluntary will and imagination**. It is the capacity to want clearly, imagine vividly and choose deliberately, instead of living on autopilot, running scripts written by habit, fear or the crowd. The four freedoms:

1. **Freedom of imagination:** the ability to picture a future, and a self, that does not yet exist.

2. **Freedom of choice:** the pause in which a person decides rather than reacts.
3. **Freedom of form:** the ability to adopt the role the moment needs, student, leader, listener, without losing yourself.
4. **Freedom of desire:** the discipline of wanting the right things, and wanting them cleanly.

Analogy: The Director's Chair

Think of two people on a film set. One is an actor who reads the line he is handed. The other is the director who decides what the scene is for. Most of us live as actors in our own life, reading lines handed to us by childhood, by the crowd and by the last thing we saw on a screen. Prakamya is the moment you stand up and say: *cut, let us film it again, this time on purpose.*

Another image: a potter's wheel. The clay is not forced; it is guided. The potter's will, steady hands and imagined shape together turn a lump into a vessel. A mind without Prakamya is a lump of wet clay on a wheel nobody is touching.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

The Bhagavad Gita (6.5) says: *lift yourself by yourself; do not let yourself sink, for the self alone is the friend of the self, and the self alone is the enemy of the self.* That is Prakamya as responsibility: the one who can choose is the one who can be blamed, and also the one who can be freed.

Viktor Frankl, in *Man's Search for Meaning*, wrote that the last of the human freedoms is to choose one's attitude in any given set of circumstances. A famous line about a space between stimulus and response is often attributed to him, though its origin is uncertain; the idea itself, though, is exactly Prakamya: freedom lives in the gap. Our task is to widen it.

How to Acquire It

1. **Hold a weekly design hour.** Once a week, sit with a notebook and ask three questions: *What do I want next week to look like? Who do I want to be in it? What will I say no to?*
2. **Rehearse with if-then sentences.** Decide in advance how you will behave in a predictable hard moment: *If I feel the urge to snap, then I will take one breath and ask a question.* Research on implementation intentions suggests that such small, specific plans make behaviour far more likely to follow intention.
3. **Audit your desires.** List ten things you want. Next to each, write whether *you* want it or whether you picked it up from someone else. Keep the ones that are yours.
4. **Try a new form.** For one week, play a role that does not come naturally: the patient listener, the early riser, the one who speaks plainly. Roles you have tried are roles you can choose.

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Ask: *What kind of person do I choose to be today?* Name one quality.
- **During the day:** Catch one automatic reaction and replace it with one chosen response.
- **Evening:** Write: *Today I chose…* and finish the sentence once.

> **THE TRADER'S MIRROR**
>
> A trader without Prakamya is an actor reading lines from the last headline, the loudest chat group or his own old fear. A trader with Prakamya rehearses *himself*: how he will behave after a

> loss, after a big win, on a dull day, on a wild one. He does not need to predict the market; he pre-decides his own conduct. The market becomes a scene in a film he is directing, not a storm he is drowning in.

How It Goes Wrong

The shadow of Prakamya is **fantasy**: imagination without ground. The dreamer who pictures a result and mistakes the picture for progress is not exercising free will; he is watching a film of himself. Imagination must be bolted to action and to Garima's weight. The test is simple: what is the smallest thing I will *do* about this imagined future by tomorrow?

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 9

- Prakamya is the freedom to imagine, choose and take the form the moment needs.
- Four freedoms: imagination, choice, form, desire.
- Image to hold: the director's chair versus the actor's script.
- Gita 6.5: the self is its own friend and its own enemy.
- Daily rep: a weekly design hour and one if-then sentence.
- The shadow is fantasy; the cure is action grounded in Garima.

CHAPTER 10

Ishitva (□□□□□□): The Power of Command

The power of mastery over the forces within and around

The Story

When Ravana's men wrap Hanuman's tail in cloth and set it on fire to humiliate him, the story turns. The fire that was meant to torment him does not burn him. Hanuman grows, leaps from roof to roof, and Lanka burns. It is a thrilling scene. But the part most readers forget comes after the fire. Standing on the shore, looking at the burning city, Hanuman is suddenly seized by dread: *what if Sita was in that fire?* His own fury, once released, had not asked whom it would touch. Only when he learns she is safe does he breathe again.

This is Ishitva with its honest shadow. The power of command over fire, over forces, is real, and the first force it must command is the one within the commander. Forces released in anger are forces released blindly. Mastery means steering the fire and knowing, before the match is lit, where it will fall.

The Main Idea

Ishitva is the power of **lordship over forces**: the capacity to steer the great inner energies, fear, anger, greed, excitement, grief, lust, envy, instead of being steered by them. An emotion is not an enemy. It is energy. The untrained person is swept along by it; the trained person *channels* it. The four commands:

1. **Command of recognition:** noticing the force at the moment it rises and naming it.

2. **Command of the body:** using breath, posture and movement to settle the physical side of an emotion.
3. **Command of interpretation:** reframing what the force is telling you, so it informs rather than rules.
4. **Command of timing:** deciding *when* to act on the energy, and often, to wait.

Analogy: The Charioteer

The Katha Upanishad offers one of the most precise models of Ishitva in world literature. The self, it says, is the rider in a chariot; the body is the chariot; the intellect is the charioteer; the mind is the reins; and the senses are the horses. A chariot without a trained charioteer is a runaway. Anger, fear and greed are powerful horses, and nobody wants them gone, because a chariot without horses goes nowhere. What matters is who holds the reins.

A second image: a river and a canal. A river in flood destroys villages. The same water, led through a canal, irrigates a thousand fields. The force is identical. The difference is direction. Ishitva is the engineer's patient work of digging the canal before the flood comes.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

The Bhagavad Gita (2.62-63) traces the chain with the precision of a clinician: dwelling on objects of desire creates attachment; attachment gives birth to craving; craving, when blocked, to anger; anger to delusion; delusion to loss of memory; loss of memory to the destruction of intelligence. Read it as a flowchart of how a calm person becomes a reckless one, one link at a time. Break the chain at the *first* link and the rest never happen.

Aristotle, in the Nicomachean Ethics, observes that anyone can become angry, but to be angry with the right person, to the right degree, at the right time, for the right purpose and in the right way is not easy. That is Ishitva in Greek dress: not the absence of the force, but its *right measure*.

How to Acquire It

1. **Name it to tame it.** When an emotion surges, say its name in one word: *fear*, *envy*, *itch*, *anger*. Research on affect labelling suggests that naming a feeling reduces its grip.
2. **Use the long exhale.** Two slow breaths, with the out-breath longer than the in-breath, signal the body that the emergency is over.
3. **Build a cooling rule.** Decide in advance that no important decision will be made within a set period after a strong emotion. Write the rule down while you are calm.
4. **Channel it.** Convert the energy into movement: a fast walk, a set of push-ups, a hard task. Anger that lifts weights does less harm than anger that sends messages.

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Ask: *Which force is most likely to visit me today?* Name it and decide how you will meet it.
- **During the day:** When it arrives, say: *I see you, fear*. Breathe out slowly. Delay the decision.
- **Evening:** Write one moment when a force rose and one choice you made about it.

> **THE TRADER'S MIRROR**
>
> A trading day is a sequence of invitations to the four great forces: fear when a position moves against you, greed when it moves for

> you, anger when you are wrong, and excitement when everything is moving. The trader's craft is not to eliminate them; it is to notice which horse is pulling, and to hold the reins. The Emotional Entry, a paradox you will meet later in this book, is simply what happens when the horse is steering the charioteer.

How It Goes Wrong

The shadow of Ishitva is **suppression**: clamping the lid on emotion and calling it control. A suppressed force does not disappear; it rises later in a worse form. Real command is not silence but fluency: the ability to feel the force fully and still choose what to do next. If your calm is brittle, it is not command; it is a lid on a pot.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 10

- Ishitva is mastery over inner forces: recognition, body, interpretation, timing.
- Story: Hanuman's dread after the fire; command must include foresight.
- Images to hold: the charioteer and the reins; the river and the canal.
- Gita 2.62-63: break the chain at the first link.
- Daily rep: name it, long exhale, cooling rule.
- The shadow is suppression; real command is fluency, not silence.

CHAPTER 11

Vashitva (□□□□□□): The Power of Self-Governance

The power of bringing anyone and anything under one's influence, beginning with oneself

The Story

The image for Vashitva is a calm figure seated among a lion, an elephant, a cobra and a bull: four creatures that, in nature, would never share a clearing. The descriptive line says the power is that of bringing anyone and anything under one's influence. Yet the real wonder is not in the animals. It is in the stillness of the one at the centre. Predators do not rule him. They sit.

The deepest Vashitva story belongs to Hanuman's night in Lanka. Searching for Sita, he walks through Ravana's palace and sees sleeping women, jewelled and unguarded. A thought crosses his mind: *have I done wrong, looking where I should not?* He examines his own mind with honesty, and concludes that it is undisturbed, because he is searching for one person and for no other purpose. He says, in effect, that the mind is the real cause of right and wrong action, and his mind is clean. The power to command the world begins with the courage to audit yourself.

The Main Idea

Vashitva is the power of **self-governance**: mastery over senses, habits, time, speech and company. If Ishitva is command over the weather inside you, Vashitva is command over the *house* in which the weather happens. It is the siddhi that holds the keys to

the other seven, because without self-rule, none of the other powers can be applied on purpose. The four territories:

1. **Governance of senses and habits:** deciding what reaches your eyes, ears and hands, and what does not.
2. **Governance of time:** treating your hours as the capital they are.
3. **Governance of speech:** speaking by decision, not by itch.
4. **Governance of company:** choosing, carefully, whose voices you let become your inner voices.

Analogy: The Gatekeeper of the City

Picture your mind as a walled city with gates. Notifications, rumours, headlines, temptations and opinions arrive daily, many of them genuinely appealing. An ungoverned city leaves every gate open and wonders why the market square is so noisy. A governed city has a gatekeeper who asks each visitor a simple question: *what is your business here?* Most visitors have none and are turned away without anger. The city does not become small; it becomes sovereign.

Another image: the thermostat. A thermometer only reports the temperature of the room. A thermostat *sets* it. Most people are thermometers: they report on how they feel and what their day is doing to them. Vashitva is the decision to become a thermostat.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

The Gita (2.58) offers a famous image: the one of steady wisdom withdraws the senses from their objects, as a tortoise draws in its limbs. Notice that the tortoise does not lose its limbs. It governs *when* they are out. The Book of Proverbs (16:32) states the matching principle in a Hebrew idiom: better to be slow to anger than mighty, and better to rule one's own spirit than to

capture a city. The conqueror of cities is admired for a day; the ruler of himself is trusted for a lifetime.

The Stoics built an entire philosophy on this. Epictetus teaches that no one is free who is not master of himself. And the Chalisa's own title for Hanuman, *jitendriya*, the one who has conquered the senses, shows that this siddhi was recognised, in his own tradition, as the root of the others.

How to Acquire It

1. **Do a one-week habit audit.** For seven days, write down every time you reach for your phone, a snack or a distraction *without deciding to*. Count them. Awareness alone usually halves the number.
2. **Design your environment.** Make the good choice easy and the bad choice slightly harder: the phone in another room during focused work, the notification switched off, the calendar blocked. Governance is mostly architecture.
3. **Guard the first hour.** Whatever you do in the first hour tends to set the tone of the day. Decide it in advance and protect it.
4. **Ask the gatekeeper's question.** Before any action you notice yourself drifting into, ask: *Did I decide this, or did it happen?*

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Choose three things that will get your best attention today, and one thing you will refuse.
- **During the day:** Each time you catch yourself on autopilot, say: *I decide.* Then decide.

- **Evening:** Count your autopilot moments. Notice whether the number falls week by week.

> **THE TRADER'S MIRROR**
>
> The market is the most inviting open gate a modern person has ever carried in his pocket. Prices, chatter, tips, rumours, other people's wins and losses: all of them arrive on demand. A trader without Vashitva is a city with no wall. A trader with Vashitva decides which hours he looks, which voices he hears, and which urges he does not obey. That decision, taken once and protected daily, is worth more than any piece of information.

How It Goes Wrong

The counterfeit of Vashitva is **control of others**: the person who, unable to govern himself, tries to govern everyone around him. A person who nags, manipulates or dominates is displaying the absence of the power, not its presence. Real self-governance is quiet and mostly invisible. It also needs Anima's humility: the ruler who cannot be corrected becomes a tyrant, even of a kingdom of one.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 11

- Vashitva is self-governance: senses, habits, time, speech, company.
- Story: the calm figure among the lion, elephant, cobra and bull; Hanuman's honest self-audit in Lanka.
- Images to hold: the gatekeeper of the city; the thermostat versus the thermometer.
- Gita 2.58: the tortoise draws in its limbs; governance is choosing *when* they are out.
- Daily rep: the habit audit and the question *did I decide this?*
- The counterfeit is control of others; the cure is humility.

PART THREE

The Eleven Trading Paradoxes

Where the market tests the eight powers

CHAPTER 12

Why the Market Is the Perfect Mirror

A short map of eleven paradoxes

The Main Idea

A paradox is a situation in which the obvious move produces the opposite of the result you expect. Trading is a field *made* of paradoxes. The more you try to be right, the more you are wrong. The more you watch, the less you see. The more you trade, the less you earn. The more you want the money, the less you can think. None of these are tricks. They are what happens when a human nervous system, built for a savannah, meets a machine that prices the world every second.

The eight siddhis are the equipment for this meeting. Each paradox in this part of the book is a *specific way* the untrained mind is trapped, and each is paired with the powers that release it. You will find that the same two or three siddhis appear again and again. That is the point: eleven symptoms, eight muscles.

The Eleven at a Glance

#	Paradox	The trap in one line	Main siddhis that cure it
1	Harry Hindsight	"I knew it all along" rewrites the past and blinds the future	Prakamya, Anima
2	The Winner's Curse	The victory itself inflates the ego that will lose the next round	Anima, Garima

#	Paradox	The trap in one line	Main siddhis that cure it
3	The Employee Mindset	Treating trading like a salaried job that owes you daily pay	Vashitva, Prakamya
4	FOMO	Grasping at every passing move for fear of being left behind	Prapti, Laghima
5	The Screen Time Paradox	More hours of looking produce less clarity of seeing	Mahima, Vashitva
6	The Emotional Entry	Acting from a feeling and then calling it a decision	Ishitva, Garima
7	The Tortoise and the Hare	Speed feels productive; patience actually compounds	Garima, Anima
8	The Clutter Curse	More tools, tabs and rules make a heavier, slower mind	Laghima, Anima
9	Scaling by Volume	Many trades feel like many chances; they are mostly many costs	Anima, Mahima
10	The Boredom Tax	Quiet time is a cost the restless mind pays by overtrading	Vashitva, Garima
11	The Dollar Sign Delusion	Mistaking rupees on the screen for the score of your worth	All eight, led by Prakamya

A note on the last paradox. The “Dollar Sign Delusion” is a well-known name for the habit of seeing every outcome as a pile of money. Because this book is written for readers who count in rupees, we will examine it in rupees, with Indian examples, from the ₹500 you pay in costs on a bad day to the ₹5 lakh that can seem like destiny.

Analogy: The Wind Tunnel

Engineers test a car in a wind tunnel not because the road is a wind tunnel, but because the tunnel makes invisible forces visible. The market is a wind tunnel for the mind. In ordinary life, your impatience, vanity, fear and greed hide inside a hundred polite routines. In the market, they hit your face at speed and show up on a statement, in rupees, by evening. Be grateful to the tunnel. It will teach you in weeks what ordinary life takes years to say.

A Note on Characters

The short stories that open the paradox chapters feature composite characters: invented figures built from patterns that traders of every country will recognise. Any resemblance to a real person is a coincidence of human nature, not of biography. And, as promised, there are no strategies in them. Their entries and exits are never described, because those are never the point.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 12

- A paradox is an obvious move that produces the opposite result.
- The market is a wind tunnel: it makes invisible psychological forces visible, and prices them.
- Eleven paradoxes map back to eight powers; the same few muscles keep appearing.
- The rupee is the lens for the last paradox; money is the loudest and least accurate scorekeeper.

CHAPTER 13

Paradox One: Harry Hindsight

The person who always knew it would happen, afterwards

The Story

Meet Harry. After every big move, Harry tells his friends: "I saw that coming." When the index jumped three percent in a morning, he said it had been obvious for a week. When it fell the following Tuesday, he said it had been obvious for a month. Harry has never once written a prediction down before the fact. His memory edits itself so smoothly that he honestly believes he was right every time. And since he feels so right so often, he takes larger and larger risks. The only person Harry has fooled is Harry.

The Paradox

The better the past looks in hindsight, the worse your judgement becomes about the future. Psychologists call this hindsight bias, the "I knew it all along" effect, first studied systematically by Baruch Fischhoff in the 1970s. After an outcome is known, the mind rearranges its memories to make the outcome seem inevitable. The result is a false confidence: if everything was so predictable, then the future must be predictable too, and a person who believes that will size his bets by certainty he never had.

The Main Idea

Hindsight turns a river of uncertainty into a straight road, but only looking backward. At the time you stood on the bank, there

were a hundred possible paths and no road. Four symptoms show Harry at work in you:

1. **Rewriting memory:** you recall your earlier view as closer to the outcome than it really was.
2. **Outcome judging:** you call a decision good because it worked, or bad because it did not, ignoring the quality of the reasoning.
3. **Overconfidence:** a "clean" past makes you believe your next call is clear.
4. **Humility loss:** you stop asking what you did not know.

Analogy: The Maze Seen From Above

Standing at the entrance of a maze, every turn is uncertain. Seen from a balcony afterward, the correct path looks like a trivial line, and you wonder how anyone could have missed it. Harry looks at the maze from the balcony, forgets he ever stood in it, and tells newcomers the maze is easy.

A second image: the cricket commentator. After a wicket falls, the commentator explains exactly why the batsman was doomed. Five minutes earlier the same commentator was praising the same shot. The commentary is always perfect because it is always written after the ball.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

The Gita (2.47) restates the central point: you control the action, not the result. A mind that confuses the two will judge itself by results alone, which is exactly Harry's error. And Socrates' famous admission, that his wisdom consisted of knowing that he did not know, is the original antidote to hindsight: the wise person begins from ignorance, not from the story he tells afterward. Daniel Kahneman, who spent a career studying such

biases, wrote that we are prone to overestimate how much we understand about the world, and that hindsight is one of the mechanisms that makes the illusion feel so natural.

The Siddhis That Cure It

Prakamya is the honest imagination of the future *as a spread of possibilities*, not as a single story. **Anima** shrinks the ego enough to say, "I did not know." Together they replace Harry's single confident line with a fan of outcomes.

How to Acquire the Cure

1. **Write before the fact.** Before any significant decision, write two lines: *what I expect*, and *how confident I am, as a percentage*. Dated, on paper.
2. **Judge the reasoning, not the result.** In review, ask two separate questions: *Was my thinking sound?* and *Did it work out?* They are different questions.
3. **Keep a "what I did not know" column.** In every review, list at least one thing you could not have known at the time.
4. **Swap "I knew it" for "it fits."** Train your language. After a surprise, say: *that fits a pattern I did not see*.

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Write one prediction about your own day (not the market), with a confidence figure.
- **During the day:** When you hear yourself say "I knew it," stop and ask: *Where is the written proof?*
- **Evening:** Compare your written predictions with what happened. Score yourself honestly.

How It Goes Wrong

The cure can turn into **paralysis**: so much doubt about the past that you refuse to ever decide. That is not Anima but self-erasure. The point is not to hate your judgement; it is to keep a fair record of it, and to remain humble enough to learn.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 13

- Hindsight bias rewrites memory so outcomes look inevitable.
- Result: false confidence, bigger risk, and no learning.
- Image to hold: the maze from the balcony; the commentator after the ball.
- Gita 2.47: you control the action, not the result; judge process, not outcome.
- Daily rep: write the prediction and the confidence *before* the fact.
- Cure: Prakamya (a fan of futures) plus Anima (I did not know).

CHAPTER 14

Paradox Two: The Winner's Curse

The victory that poisons the next round

The Story

Latha, a composite trader, had a spectacular fortnight. Her account grew faster than it ever had. She told her family she had finally "cracked it." She raised her risk, skipped her usual end-of-day review ("I'm on a roll, why slow down?") and started telling younger traders how it was done. Within three weeks, one ordinary losing run took back the entire gain, then more. She did not lose because she was untalented. She lost because the win quietly replaced her humility with certainty.

The Paradox

Winning can make you worse at winning. The phrase "winner's curse" has a technical origin in economics: in auctions where bidders cannot know the true value of what they are bidding for, the *winner* tends to be the one who overestimated it the most, and therefore pays too much. Richard Thaler popularised the idea in behavioural economics. In trading, the curse has a second, psychological meaning: the victory inflates your self-image and raises the stakes of your next decision, just when you most need to stay small.

The Main Idea

A win is information, not a verdict. In a world full of luck, a win might mean skill, or it might mean you were standing in the right place when the wind turned. Four symptoms show the curse at work:

1. **Attribution error:** you credit skill for wins and bad luck for losses.
2. **Risk creep:** the win makes you feel immune, so you take larger risks.
3. **Process decay:** you drop the habits (reviews, rules, rest) that produced the win.
4. **Advice-giving:** you begin teaching before you have finished learning.

Analogy: The Auction Hall

Imagine an auction for a sealed jar of coins. Everyone guesses the amount. Some guess too low, some too high. Who wins the auction? The person who guessed *highest*, who is most likely to have overestimated and overpaid. Winning, in that room, is itself a clue that you may have been wrong. A wise bidder reads his own victory as a warning light.

A second image: the cricket batsman after a century. The great ones take guard again as if the score were zero. The innings so far is history; the next ball does not know about it.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

The Bhagavad Gita (2.38) asks the warrior to treat pleasure and pain, gain and loss, victory and defeat as the same before he enters the fight. Equanimity at the moment of victory is the whole teaching. Rudyard Kipling's poem "If—" calls triumph and disaster two impostors and asks the reader to treat both the same. And the Tao Te Ching (chapter 9) warns that to keep on filling a bowl past its brim is worse than to stop in time. The Greeks had a word, *hubris*, for what happens to the winner who forgets he is mortal.

The Siddhis That Cure It

Anima shrinks the swollen self back to size: *I am a small participant in a large process.* **Garima** supplies the weight to keep your routines, rules and reviews unchanged on a day when you feel like skipping them.

How to Acquire the Cure

1. **Keep the routine identical after a win.** The review, the rest, the rules: unchanged. Treat a good day with exactly the same procedure as a bad one.
2. **Write the luck column.** After every win, write down at least two things that were outside your control and helped you.
3. **Pause before raising stakes.** A cooling-off period, set in advance, before any increase in risk following a gain.
4. **Be a student after a win.** Ask one person who has more experience than you: *what did I miss?*

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** After a good stretch, read your non-negotiables aloud, twice.
- **During the day:** If you notice a thought like "I've figured this out," treat it as a symptom.
- **Evening:** Write: *what luck helped me today?*

How It Goes Wrong

Overcorrecting turns the cure into **joylessness**: refusing to enjoy a good result for fear of cursing it. Hanuman accepted garlands of praise and passed them straight to Rama. Be glad, thank those who helped, and then return to size.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 14

- The winner of an auction is often the one who overestimated most; a win is information, not a verdict.
- In trading, wins inflate ego, raise risk, and tempt you to drop your process.
- Image to hold: the sealed jar; the batsman who takes guard again.
- Gita 2.38: treat gain and loss, victory and defeat alike.
- Daily rep: the luck column and an unchanged routine.
- Cure: Anima (return to size) plus Garima (keep the routine heavy).

CHAPTER 15

Paradox Three: The Employee Mindset

The business that owes you no salary

The Story

Mohan left a steady job to trade full time. He brought something with him that he did not notice: the clock. He sat at his desk at 9:15, left at 3:30, and felt that a day without profit was a day he had "worked for nothing." At month end he felt entitled to a "salary" from the market. When the market did not pay it, he pushed harder, took trades he did not believe in, and told himself it was because he "had to earn." Mohan had left his employer but built a new boss in his head, one who demanded a payment the market never promised.

The Paradox

The more you treat trading as a job, the worse you trade it. A job pays for time and effort, whether or not the results are good. A market pays only for results, and only sometimes. The employee mindset attaches *hours* to *income*, and that mismatch breeds forced trades, resentment on slow days, and the corrosive feeling that the market owes you for showing up.

The Main Idea

A trader is closer to a farmer, a fisherman or a business owner than an employee. There are days to plant, days to wait, and days when the sea is closed. The paycheque logic of "effort in, money out" does not apply. Four marks of the employee mindset:

1. **Time-for-money thinking:** feeling that sitting there entitles you to a return.
2. **Forced activity:** needing to "do something" so the day is not wasted.
3. **Boss-hunting:** wanting someone (a guru, a signal) to tell you what to do and take the blame.
4. **Salary expectations:** judging the month by whether it "paid."

Analogy: The Fisherman and the Clerk

A clerk is paid to sit at the counter eight hours, and gets paid even on days when no customer arrives. A fisherman goes out when the sea allows. Some days he returns with a full net, some days with nothing, and he does not feel cheated. He accepts that his craft rewards *readiness and judgement*, not mere presence. The trader who sits like a clerk but is paid like a fisherman will be depressed within a year.

A second image: the shopkeeper's ledger. A good shopkeeper does not ask whether each day "paid." He asks whether the shop, over a season, is healthy. His unit of measurement is the quarter, not the hour.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

The Gita (2.47) is the original teaching against the employee mindset: *you have a right to your duty, never to its fruits.* The employee demands the fruits for the hours. The karma-yogi does the work and lets the result be what it is. And Warren Buffett is often quoted as saying that the stock market transfers money from the impatient to the patient. Whether or not those are his exact words, the idea is the same: patience is a business skill, not a personality trait.

The Siddhis That Cure It

Vashitva takes back authority over your own time and your own boss. **Prakamya** reminds you that you chose this path freely, and can choose its design: your hours, your standards, your definition of a good day.

How to Acquire the Cure

1. **Redefine a good day.** Write your own measure that does not depend on rupees: *I followed my rules; I journaled; I stayed calm.*
2. **Separate work from trade count.** Preparation, review and study are the work. Action on the screen is only a small share of it.
3. **Fire the imaginary boss.** Notice the voice that says "you must produce today," and answer: *no one asked me to.*
4. **Set "market closed" days.** Decide in advance days or hours when you will not trade, and treat them as part of the business.

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Say: *My job today is to behave well, not to earn.*
- **During the day:** On a quiet screen, do the study or review and leave the platform alone.
- **Evening:** Score the day on process only.

How It Goes Wrong

Overdone, the cure becomes **hobbyism**: no structure, no standards, no seriousness. The owner mindset is *more* demanding than the employee mindset, not less. You are the

owner, the manager and the worker, and no one will cover for you.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 15

- Jobs pay for time; markets pay (sometimes) for results.
- The employee mindset breeds forced trades, resentment and boss-hunting.
- Image to hold: the fisherman versus the clerk; the shopkeeper's ledger.
- Gita 2.47: right to action, not to fruits.
- Daily rep: define a good day by process, not by rupees.
- Cure: Vashitva (own your time) plus Prakamya (design your own business).

CHAPTER 16

Paradox Four: FOMO

The fear of missing out that makes you miss everything

The Story

Divya, a composite trader, watched a stock rise all morning from the sidelines. She had no plan for it. She had no reason to be in it. But the chat group was lit up with screenshots, and each new green candle felt like a door closing. At the highest-feeling moment she jumped in, and the move reversed. “Of course it did,” she said later. “It always does when I join.” It does not always. But she joined from fear, not from a decision, and that is why it felt that way.

The Paradox

The harder you chase every opportunity, the more opportunities you miss, and the worse the ones you catch. FOMO is the anxious feeling that others are gaining something you are not. Psychologists have studied it in social media; in markets it takes a financial form. It makes the present move look like the *last* bus, when in fact the stop is full of buses.

The Main Idea

The mind treats missed gains like real losses, though they are only imaginary ones. And once you feel the pain of a loss that never happened, you will pay almost anything to stop it. Four marks of FOMO:

1. **Comparison:** measuring yourself against screenshots, not against your own plan.

2. **Urgency:** the sense that this is the only door, and it is closing now.
3. **Plan-skipping:** acting with no prior thought about the idea.
4. **Late arrival:** joining at the loudest, and most crowded, moment.

Analogy: The Bus That Never Stops Coming

A person at a busy bus stop in a metropolis who runs after every bus will arrive nowhere, and will be exhausted. Another person who knows his number waits calmly, and boards his bus when it arrives. There is no shortage of buses in a market. The only scarce resource is *your* attention and capital.

A second image: the reaching hand and the grasping hand from Chapter 8. FOMO is a grasping hand wearing the costume of reach.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

The Isha Upanishad's opening says not to covet anyone's wealth. Seneca wrote that we suffer more often in imagination than in reality. And the Gita (2.62) describes the very chain that FOMO follows: dwelling on an object creates attachment, and attachment gives birth to craving. The cure begins before the chart: in where you let your mind dwell.

The Siddhis That Cure It

Prapti is the mature form of reach: preparation, patience and the quiet confidence that what is truly yours cannot be missed, because you built the rope. **Laghima** is the lightness that lets a move go by without a pang: *that one was not mine.*

How to Acquire the Cure

1. **Create a "missed" list.** Write down what you passed on, and what happened afterward. Review it monthly. Most of what you miss was never going to suit you.
2. **Limit your comparison diet.** Mute the groups and screenshots that make you feel behind.
3. **Say the sentence.** When the urge rises: *That is not mine today.* Then breathe out.
4. **Prepare your own list.** If you have not thought about an idea before it moves, you do not have the right to act on it during the move.

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Name the opportunity you are *willing to miss* today.
- **During the day:** When the urge to join the crowd appears, name it: *FOMO*. Breathe out slowly. Wait.
- **Evening:** Write one thing you let go of today, and notice that you survived.

How It Goes Wrong

The cure can slide into **paralysis by pride**: refusing to act on anything the crowd also likes, simply to be different. That is contrarianism, not freedom. The aim is not to avoid the crowd. It is to be *free of it*, so you can act when your own preparation says so, whoever else agrees.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 16

- FOMO treats imaginary missed gains like real losses.

- It causes plan-skipping, urgency and late, crowded entries.
- Image to hold: the bus stop; the grasping hand dressed as reaching.
- Seneca: we suffer more in imagination than in reality.
- Daily rep: *That is not mine today*; keep a “missed” list.
- Cure: Prapti (reach with preparation) plus Laghima (let it pass).

CHAPTER 17

Paradox Five: The Screen Time Paradox

More hours of looking, less clarity of seeing

The Story

Karthik, a composite trader, once bragged that he watched the markets for ten hours a day. He knew every flicker of every price. He also knew that his mood changed with each of them: a good hour, a good mood; a bad hour, a bad one. At the end of the month he checked his results. His best weeks were not his longest screen weeks. They were the weeks he had stepped away, done other things, and returned for brief, deliberate sessions. He had mistaken *attention paid* for *attention quality*.

The Paradox

The more time you spend looking, the less you see. Constant exposure to price movement makes every small wiggle feel meaningful, shrinks your time horizon to minutes, and wears out the very faculty you rely on: your judgement. It is the trader's version of the old observation that staring at a word for too long makes it look strange.

The Main Idea

Attention is a finite resource, like fuel. Continuous screen time spends it on noise. Four costs of the paradox:

1. **Noise absorption:** your mind begins treating random movement as meaningful.

2. **Time-horizon collapse:** you live in minutes, so every tick feels like destiny.
3. **Decision fatigue:** by afternoon, your judgement is thinner.
4. **Emotional contagion:** the screen's mood becomes your mood.

Analogy: The Too-Close Painting

Stand with your nose an inch from a great painting and you see only brushstrokes, cracks and dust. Step back ten feet and the picture emerges. The screen is the painting; screen time is how close you stand. A good trader learns the correct viewing distance and uses his feet.

A second image: a chef tasting the soup. A cook who tastes every thirty seconds does not make better soup; he makes cold, worried soup. A skilled cook checks at the right moments and trusts the pot between them.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

Seneca opens *On the Shortness of Life* with the observation that it is not that we have a short time to live, but that we waste a great deal of it. Thoreau, in *Walden*, wrote that the cost of a thing is the amount of life exchanged for it. And the Gita (2.58) describes the tortoise drawing in its limbs as the image of a steady mind: the ability to withdraw attention from the senses when they are not helping.

The Siddhis That Cure It

Mahima is the wide lens: step back, see the long film, remember that a day is one frame. **Vashitva** is the gatekeeper: *who decided I would be at this screen for ten hours?*

How to Acquire the Cure

1. **Set viewing windows.** Decide in advance when you will look and when you will not, and keep the windows short.
2. **Log your attention.** For a week, note how long you actually watch, and how your mood moves with it.
3. **Use the distance walk.** Every hour, step away for five minutes and look at something far off: the horizon, a tree, the sky.
4. **Review weekly, not hourly.** Let the time frame of your reflection match the time frame of your goals.

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Write the hours you will look at the screen today, and the hours you will not.
- **During the day:** On the hour, stand, stretch, look far, breathe out.
- **Evening:** Write one thing you noticed when you were *not* looking.

How It Goes Wrong

The cure fails when it becomes **avoidance**: not looking because you are afraid of what you will see. Stepping back is a decision, not a hiding place. You must return, calm and on purpose.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 17

- More screen time produces more noise, not more clarity.
- Costs: noise absorption, time-horizon collapse, fatigue, emotional contagion.

- Image to hold: the painting seen too close; the chef who tastes every thirty seconds.
- Seneca and Thoreau: time and life are the real price of everything.
- Daily rep: fixed viewing windows and the hourly distance walk.
- Cure: Mahima (zoom out) plus Vashitva (govern your hours).

CHAPTER 18

Paradox Six: The Emotional Entry

The decision that was really a feeling

The Story

Rahim, a composite trader, had a loss in the morning, a small one by his own standards. By noon, he was irritated. By one o'clock, he told himself he was "just taking a look." At 1:40, he acted, in a size larger than usual, in an idea he had not prepared, for a reason he could not explain except to say: *I need to get it back.* The action felt like a decision. It was a reflex. Later he looked at his own notes and found not a single line of reasoning for that moment. There was only a feeling wearing a decision's clothes.

The Paradox

The stronger the feeling behind an action, the less it feels like a feeling. Emotion does not announce itself. It presents itself as urgency, as obviousness, as "common sense." The emotional entry is dangerous precisely because it feels decisive. A calm decision feels slow and uncertain; an emotional one feels like clarity.

The Main Idea

Every emotion carries an instruction: fear says *flee*, anger says *fight*, greed says *grab*, boredom says *do something*. These instructions were built for a savannah, not for a screen. Four disguises an emotional entry wears:

1. **Revenge:** acting to "get back" a loss.
2. **Euphoria:** acting because a gain feels like permission.

3. **Boredom:** acting because nothing is happening.
4. **Panic:** acting because something is.

Analogy: The Horse Without a Rider

Recall the chariot of the Katha Upanishad. An emotional entry is what happens when the horses are driving. They are strong, they are fast, they are sincere. They are also running towards the nearest smell of grass. The charioteer's job is not to hate the horses. It is to hold the reins and say, *not yet*.

A second image: the pressure cooker. Steam is not the enemy; the cooker needs it. But steam with no valve is a bomb. Ishitva is the valve.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

The chain of Gita 2.62-63 is the best map of the emotional entry ever drawn: dwelling, attachment, craving, anger, delusion, loss of memory, loss of intelligence. Notice that *loss of memory* comes late: the emotional trader forgets his own rules *in the moment*, and remembers them with perfect clarity the next morning. The Dhammapada begins with the observation that mind precedes all mental states; mind is their chief, and from the mind they are made. Marcus Aurelius adds that we have power over our mind, not over outside events.

The Siddhis That Cure It

Ishitva gives command over the force: naming it, breathing through it, delaying the act. **Garima** supplies the weight of rules written in calm: *I do not decide when I am in the grip of a strong feeling.*

How to Acquire the Cure

1. **Build a feeling check.** Before any important action, rate your emotional temperature from one to ten. Above a chosen number, you do not act.
2. **Name the disguise.** Is it revenge, euphoria, boredom or panic? Say the word aloud.
3. **Write a cooling rule.** A set pause after any loss or gain before the next decision. Written while calm; obeyed while not.
4. **Move the body.** Walk, stretch, drink water. Emotion is chemistry, and chemistry responds to movement.

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Write your cooling rule in your own words and read it.
- **During the day:** Before an action, ask: *Is this a decision or a feeling?*
- **Evening:** Write one moment when you felt the feeling, named it, and waited.

How It Goes Wrong

The danger is **suppression** (see Chapter 10): pushing the feeling down and calling it discipline. The goal is not to be a stone. The goal is to feel everything and let nothing steer without your consent.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 18

- Emotional entries feel like decisions; they are reflexes in disguise.

- Four disguises: revenge, euphoria, boredom, panic.
- Image to hold: the horses without a charioteer; the pressure cooker with no valve.
- Gita 2.62-63: the chain that ends in lost memory and lost intelligence.
- Daily rep: the feeling check and the cooling rule.
- Cure: Ishitva (command the force) plus Garima (rules written in calm).

CHAPTER 19

Paradox Seven: The Tortoise and the Hare

Speed feels productive; patience compounds

The Story

Everyone knows Aesop's fable. The hare is faster; the tortoise is steadier. The hare, sure of his speed, naps. The tortoise keeps walking and wins. We nod, then go and behave exactly like the hare. Two traders began in the same month with the same small capital. Hari, a composite, wanted fast results and doubled his activity at every setback. Tara, his mirror, wanted to be alive and learning five years from now, and grew slowly, steadily. By the end of the second year, Hari had left the market in frustration. Tara was still there, and her small, boring numbers had begun to compound.

The Paradox

The faster you try to grow, the slower you actually do. Speed feels like progress because it produces motion, but in markets, motion and progress are different animals. Haste increases cost, error and exposure to ruin. Survival, the ability to stay in the game, is the first condition of every compounding process.

The Main Idea

Compounding is the slowest-looking fast thing in the world. It rewards those who stay for a long time more than those who shine for a short one. Four lessons of the tortoise:

1. **Survive first.** A player who is still there keeps every future opportunity.
2. **Grow gently.** Small, repeated, bearable progress beats large, unsustainable leaps.
3. **Respect time.** Skill, like a banyan, grows in years, not weeks.
4. **Keep your rhythm.** A steady pace under pressure is itself a form of strength.

Analogy: The Banyan and the Gourd Vine

A gourd vine can cover a wall in a monsoon and wither within the season. A banyan grows for a century. Both are alive; only one is a tree. The market is full of gourd vines that look wonderful in July.

A second image: the pilgrim who walks the hills. He never sprints; he takes the same unhurried steps for hours, and arrives before the one who ran the first mile and sat down at the second.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

The Tao Te Ching (chapter 64) says that a journey of a thousand miles begins beneath one's feet, and that the tree that fills a man's arms grows from a tiny shoot. Buffett is widely quoted as saying that the big money is not in the buying and selling, but in the waiting, a line often credited to his partner Charlie Munger. And the Gita (6.35) teaches that the restless mind is controlled through *abhyasa*, steady practice, and *vairagya*, detachment: not a burst of effort, but a rhythm.

The Siddhis That Cure It

Garima is weight and rhythm: the daily routine that carries you through dull months. **Anima** is the willingness to take the smallest next step without demanding that it look impressive.

How to Acquire the Cure

1. **Set a pace you could keep for ten years.** Ask of every habit: *could I do this for a decade?*
2. **Celebrate boring consistency.** Track streaks of following your own process, not streaks of profit.
3. **Make growth a rule, not a mood.** Decide in advance, in calm, how you will increase effort, and never in the middle of an exciting week.
4. **Study the long graph.** Look at stories of the long-lived. Their lines are rarely steep. They are persistent.

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Say: *Today I will take the unglamorous step.*
- **During the day:** If you feel rushed, slow your speech and your clicks by one notch.
- **Evening:** Mark the day as a tick if you kept your rhythm.

How It Goes Wrong

The tortoise can become **stagnation**: the slow walker who never raises his ambition and mistakes caution for wisdom. The tortoise in the fable did not stop. He kept *moving*. Patience is a pace, not a parking spot.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 19

- Speed is motion; patience is progress.
- Survival is the first condition of compounding.
- Image to hold: the banyan versus the gourd vine; the pilgrim's steady steps.
- Tao Te Ching 64 and Gita 6.35: a thousand miles, a steady practice.
- Daily rep: choose a pace you could keep for ten years.
- Cure: Garima (rhythm) plus Anima (the smallest next step).

CHAPTER 20

Paradox Eight: The Clutter Curse

The heavier the toolbox, the slower the hand

The Story

Nisha, a composite trader, once showed a friend her workspace. Five screens. Twenty open tabs. Four group chats. Seven different tools for seeing the same thing. A notebook with forty rules, some contradicting others. She believed that she was "thorough." Yet her decisions had never been slower or less confident. Each tool had its own opinion; each rule its own exception. She could not hear herself. One day, in frustration, she closed everything but a single screen and a single page of notes. Her first day with less was the calmest she had had in months.

The Paradox

The more you add to your trading life, the less you can use. Tools, indicators, groups, courses and rules each promise clarity. Together they produce noise. Complexity feels like sophistication, but a heavy kit makes the mind slow, indecisive and easily contradicted.

The Main Idea

Clutter is not only physical. There are five kinds, and most traders carry all of them:

1. **Tool clutter:** too many screens, apps and dashboards.
2. **Information clutter:** too many opinions and sources.
3. **Rule clutter:** so many rules that none is reliably followed.

4. **Idea clutter:** too many half-learned methods, none practised deeply.
5. **Emotional clutter:** old grudges and regrets carried into new days.

Analogy: The Overpacked Backpack

A traveller who packs for every possible disaster ends up unable to climb the hill. Every item is justified; the total is crippling. The Himalayan climber's art is knowing what to leave at base camp. Each item you drop makes the climb a little more possible.

A second image: the sculptor. Michelangelo is famously reported to have said that the statue is already in the stone, and that he simply removes what is not the statue. Mastery is often subtraction.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

The Tao Te Ching (chapter 48) puts it neatly: in the pursuit of learning, one adds something each day; in the pursuit of the Way, one removes something each day. The Isha Upanishad's *enjoy through letting go* is the same teaching in spiritual dress. And the Buddha's raft is a reminder that even good tools are meant to be put down. The pattern across traditions is the same: *less, held well*, beats *more, held badly*.

The Siddhis That Cure It

Laghima is the lightness: the habit of dropping what is not essential. **Anima** helps you shrink your focus to one narrow, well-lit lane.

How to Acquire the Cure

1. **The one-page rule.** Compress your guiding principles to one page, then try to compress that page to ten lines.
2. **Subtract once a week.** Each week, remove one tool, one chat or one tab. If you miss nothing in seven days, it was clutter.
3. **Choose a small circle.** Decide which two or three sources of input you will trust, and mute the rest.
4. **Clear the emotional shelf.** In your evening review, name the one thing you will not carry into tomorrow.

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Open only what you need for today. Close everything else.
- **During the day:** If you open a new tab, ask: *which old one does this replace?*
- **Evening:** Remove one small thing from your space or from your mind.

How It Goes Wrong

The cure can slide into **neglect**: throwing out what is actually useful, like your journal or your risk habits, in a fit of minimalism. Lightness is not emptiness. It is *the right amount*.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 20

- Complexity feels like sophistication; it behaves like drag.
- Five clutters: tools, information, rules, ideas, emotions.
- Image to hold: the overpacked backpack; the sculptor who removes.

- Tao Te Ching 48: in the pursuit of the Way, remove something each day.
- Daily rep: subtract one thing per week; one page of principles.
- Cure: Laghima (drop) plus Anima (narrow focus).

CHAPTER 21

Paradox Nine: Scaling by Volume

More trades, more chances, more costs

The Story

Sandeep, a composite trader, believed in "more at-bats." If ten trades a day gave him ₹2,000 on a good day, then thirty trades should give him ₹6,000. He raised his activity. His good days became a little better; his bad days became much worse. At the end of the quarter he opened his statement and counted what had gone out the door: brokerage, taxes and charges on every single order, and the small, invisible gap between the price he wanted and the price he got. The total, spread across hundreds of trades, was larger than his entire profit. His activity was real. His "scaling" was an illusion.

The Paradox

More trades feel like more chances to make money, but are mostly more chances to pay. Volume scales *costs* and *errors* faster than it scales *edge*. This is not only a feeling. In India, official studies of individual futures and options traders by the market regulator have repeatedly found that a large majority of such traders lose money, with transaction costs forming a heavy part of the drag. Look up the latest figures for yourself; the pattern has been stable across years.

The Main Idea

Scaling should mean *more result for the same effort*. Scaling by volume means *more effort for the same result*, plus a bill. Four hidden bills on every extra trade:

1. **Explicit costs:** brokerage, statutory taxes and exchange charges, paid in rupees on every order, win or lose.
2. **Slippage:** the gap between the price you hoped for and the price you got.
3. **Attention cost:** each trade takes a slice of the finite attention you need for judgement.
4. **Emotional cost:** every position is a small emotional load; thirty positions are thirty loads.

> **A RUPEE ILLUSTRATION**
>
> Imagine that the all-in cost of a round trip (all charges plus slippage) is ₹150 for one of your trades. Ten trades a day cost ₹1,500; across 20 trading days that is ₹30,000 a month before you have made a rupee of profit. Thirty trades a day cost ₹4,500; across 20 days, ₹90,000. These numbers are illustrations, not quotations of any broker's rates, but the arithmetic is the lesson: your *break-even* moves up with every extra order you place.

Analogy: The Leaky Bucket

Imagine filling a bucket that has a small hole. If you carry water in ten trips, you lose a little. If you carry water in a hundred trips, you lose a great deal more, because every trip wets the road. Carrying more water more often is not the fix; reducing the leaks is. In trading, every order is a trip to the well.

A second image: the farmer who plants more seeds than his land can feed. More seeds do not mean a larger harvest; they mean crowded, stunted plants. The farmer's art is spacing.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

The Gita (3.5) says that no one can remain for even a moment without action; yet 2.47 clarifies that the question is not whether to act but how: with attention on the action itself and not on its

rewards. Many hands, many movements, is not the same as right action. And the Tao Te Ching's image of doing less, wu wei, is the philosophical cousin of this chapter: the master accomplishes by not meddling.

The Siddhis That Cure It

Anima is smallness of scale: fewer, more attended actions. **Mahima** is the wide lens that measures progress over months, not over an hour: *real scaling* is the growth of your skill and your steadiness, not the growth of your order count.

How to Acquire the Cure

1. **Count your costs.** For one month, total every rupee you paid in charges. Read the figure aloud.
2. **Fix a daily ceiling.** Decide, in calm, a maximum number of decisions per day. When you reach it, close the platform.
3. **Prefer quality of attention.** Write one line of reasoning for each decision. If you cannot write one line, the decision is not ready.
4. **Measure scaling differently.** Scale your preparation, your review and your patience. Let the order count be a result, not a goal.

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Write your decision ceiling for the day.
- **During the day:** Before each order, ask: *Is this worth its cost, in rupees and in attention?*
- **Evening:** Count the day's decisions. Note how many you can defend.

How It Goes Wrong

Over-restriction becomes **fear of acting**: so few actions that you never learn. The rule is not “do almost nothing.” It is “make each action count, and know what each action costs.”

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 21

- More trades scale costs and errors faster than they scale results.
- Four bills: explicit costs, slippage, attention, emotion.
- Image to hold: the leaky bucket; the over-seeded field.
- Rupee illustration: ₹150 a trade is ₹30,000 a month at ten trades a day, before profit.
- Daily rep: a decision ceiling and a one-line reason for each decision.
- Cure: Anima (fewer, attended actions) plus Mahima (scale skill, not order count).

CHAPTER 22

Paradox Ten: The Boredom Tax

The price of a quiet mind that cannot stay quiet

The Story

It was a dull Wednesday. Prices drifted, the news was empty, and Anand, a composite trader, felt the old itch. He told himself he would "just check" a few things. Forty minutes later, he had taken three positions he could not explain. None of them was disastrous. All of them cost him something: charges, attention and a mood he then had to repair. Boredom had collected its tax. When he later wrote in his journal, the entry for that day was one line long: *I did not like doing nothing.*

The Paradox

The less there is to do, the more we do, and the more it costs. The mind dislikes silence. Experiments have shown that many people, left alone with their thoughts for a short time, would rather give themselves mild electric shocks than sit quietly. In markets, the quiet hour is where the restless mind finds its expensive work.

The Main Idea

Boredom is not an absence. It is a force, and one of the sneakiest. It does not look like fear or anger; it looks like curiosity or "keeping busy." Four forms of the tax:

1. **Idle trades:** actions made for stimulation, not for reasons.
2. **Idle scrolling:** drifting through tabs and chats that add noise.

3. **Idle thinking:** spinning stories about what might have been.
4. **Idle mood:** a vague dissatisfaction that seeks relief in activity.

Analogy: The Empty Room

A child left alone in a room soon begins to invent games. An adult left alone with an open trading platform begins to invent trades. The room is the same; only the toys differ. The adult who can sit in an empty room with a quiet mind has learned something that most of the world's richest people cannot buy.

A second image: the still pond. When the water is left alone it clears; every stir brings the mud back. Stillness is not wasted time; it is how the water settles.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

Blaise Pascal wrote in the *Pensées* that all of humanity's problems come from man's inability to sit quietly in a room alone. The Yoga Sutras begin with the definition of yoga as the stilling of the movements of the mind (1.2). The Gita (6.35) acknowledges that the mind is restless and hard to hold, and that practice and detachment tame it. The sages did not treat stillness as a sign of laziness but as the workshop of the mind.

The Siddhis That Cure It

Vashitva is the governance of the urge: *I decide what I do with the quiet.* **Garima** is the steadiness that can sit in the quiet without leaving.

How to Acquire the Cure

1. **Plan your quiet.** Decide in advance what you will do in dull hours: read, walk, study, rest. A plan for boredom removes its power.
2. **Use the ten-minute rule.** When the urge to act arises, wait ten minutes and do something else. Most urges fade.
3. **Practise sitting.** Five minutes each day with no screen, no book, no music. Let the mind complain. Do not obey.
4. **Label it.** Say: *This is boredom, not information.*

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Write your boredom plan for the day.
- **During the day:** When the itch arrives, name it, wait ten minutes, then choose.
- **Evening:** Write: *Where did I pay the tax today? Where did I refuse to?*

How It Goes Wrong

The cure goes wrong when **stillness becomes numbness**: sitting through life as a spectator, calling dullness discipline. The goal is a mind that can be quiet *and* alert, ready, not asleep.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 22

- Boredom looks like curiosity but collects a tax: idle trades, idle scrolling, idle mood.
- Many people prefer discomfort to silence; markets exploit that.
- Image to hold: the child in the empty room; the still pond.

- Pascal and the Yoga Sutras: the mind that can sit still is the mind that can act well.
- Daily rep: a boredom plan, the ten-minute rule, five minutes of sitting.
- Cure: Vashitva (govern the urge) plus Garima (stay in the quiet).

CHAPTER 23

Paradox Eleven: The Dollar Sign Delusion

In rupees: the loudest scorekeeper and the least accurate

The Story

Meena, a composite trader, had a ₹4,000 loss on a Monday and could not eat lunch. On Tuesday she made ₹6,500 and felt she could conquer the world. Her mood on any day was the exact number at the bottom of her statement. Her husband remarked that she was behaving like a weather vane. What she had forgotten was that on Monday she had followed every rule she wrote, and on Tuesday she had broken two. The statement had graded her wrong on both days, and she believed it.

The Paradox

The more attention you give to the rupee figure, the worse your decisions about it. The "dollar sign delusion" is the habit of turning every outcome into a pile of money and every pile of money into a verdict about you. In India, the sign is ₹. The effect is the same: the number swallows the process, the process decays, and the numbers, eventually, follow it down.

The Main Idea

Money is a useful measure, and a terrible master. It measures one thing, outcomes, and measures that one thing noisily. It is silent on conduct, on health, on risk taken, on rules kept. Four distortions of the rupee lens:

1. **Scale blindness:** ₹5,000 can feel huge on one day and tiny on another, depending on mood, not on arithmetic.
2. **Life-conversion:** thinking of every rupee as "a month of rent" or "a holiday", so that a small loss feels like a lost life.
3. **Score-for-self:** reading profit as proof of worth and loss as proof of failure.
4. **Target fixation:** a number (₹10 lakh, ₹1 crore) that bends every decision towards it.

> **A RUPEE LADDER**
>
> Ask yourself, in calm, how you feel about each of these. Notice where the feeling is out of proportion to the number.
>
> ₹500 lost: a snack. ₹5,000 lost: a bad day. ₹50,000 lost: a bad month. ₹5 lakh lost: a crisis. The arithmetic is linear; the emotions are not. The *same discipline* has to hold at every rung of the ladder, or else it is not discipline but mood.

Analogy: The Scoreboard and the Game

A cricketer who watches the scoreboard after every ball plays worse than one who watches the next delivery. The scoreboard is accurate and useful, and it is *not the game*. The game is the ball in front of you. Money is the scoreboard.

A second image: the compass and the map. Profit is the map's distant mountain; process is the compass in your hand. If you stare at the mountain, you stumble on the path; if you trust the compass, the mountain approaches on its own.

Texts and Quotes That Stand Behind It

The Gita (2.47) is the oldest and cleanest cure: action is yours, fruit is not. Thoreau, in *Walden*, said that the price of a thing is the amount of life you exchange for it. Seen in rupees, that line

gets sharp: a ₹10,000 gain, bought by months of anxiety and broken sleep, may be among the most expensive things you ever owned. And a well-loved tradition around the Ramayana tells of Hanuman receiving a priceless necklace and breaking it open, bead by bead, searching each one for the name of Rama, because a jewel that did not carry his Lord's name was not worth keeping. Whatever its historical status, the story pictures a mind whose real treasure is not for sale at any price.

The Siddhis That Cure It

All eight. **Prakamya** lets you choose a scoreboard of your own. **Garima** steadies you against the daily swing. **Laghima** loosens the grip on the outcome. **Anima** shrinks the number's claim on your self. **Mahima** places the day inside a career. **Prapti** reminds you that rupees come from preparation. **Ishitva** commands the greed and fear the number stirs. **Vashitva** keeps the hand on the wheel when the number tries to drive.

How to Acquire the Cure

1. **Build a two-column ledger.** One column for rupees. One for conduct: *rules kept, calm kept, review done.* Look at the conduct column first.
2. **Delay the number.** Check the profit and loss figure once a day, at a set time, and not between.
3. **Convert gently.** When you find yourself translating a rupee amount into "months of rent," stop and ask: *what decision does this translation help me make?* Usually, none.
4. **Set a process target.** Replace the big rupee target with a repeatable weekly practice.

Internalizing It Into Daily Life

- **Morning:** Write one process goal for the day. No rupee figure.
- **During the day:** Resist glancing at the profit and loss figure between your scheduled checks.
- **Evening:** Score the day twice, once by rupees and once by conduct, and observe how often they disagree.

How It Goes Wrong

The cure fails when **money is despised**. Money is a legitimate, necessary tool, and a trader who sneers at it will neglect risk and cost. The point is to give rupees their *proper* place: a measure of results, never the measure of you.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 23

- The Dollar Sign Delusion turns rupees into a verdict about your worth.
- Distortions: scale blindness, life-conversion, score-for-self, target fixation.
- Image to hold: the scoreboard versus the game; the compass versus the mountain.
- Gita 2.47 and Thoreau: the fruit is not yours; the price is life.
- Daily rep: a two-column ledger, rupees and conduct.
- Cure: all eight powers, led by Prakamya.

PART FOUR

The Closing Verse and the Daily Life

Putting the eight powers and the eleven paradoxes into one practice

CHAPTER 24

"Ashta Siddhi Nav Nidhi Ke Daata"

The gift is already inside you

The Main Idea

We began with the verse, and we return to it. *Ashta siddhi nav nidhi ke daata, as bar deen Janaki mata.* Mother Janaki granted Hanuman the boon of being the giver of the eight siddhis and the nine treasures. Three ideas sit in that one line, and each deserves a slow reading.

Idea One: It Was Given

Hanuman did not seize the siddhis. They were granted, by a mother figure, in recognition of service. Whatever you achieve in life, whether skill, steadiness or income, arrives through a web of people, circumstances and fortune that you did not design. A trader who forgets that web becomes the Winner's Curse (Chapter 14) in human form. Gratitude is not a decoration on competence; it is part of how competence stays clean.

Idea Two: He Became a Giver

The verse does not say Hanuman *has* the siddhis. It says he *gives* them. In this tradition the highest use of power is to pass it on. For the reader of this book, that means something practical: teach what you learn, quietly, to one person. Teaching is not a favour to the student. It is the second half of learning, and it exposes every gap in your own understanding.

Idea Three: The Gift Is Already Inside

Recall Jambavan reminding Hanuman of a capacity he had forgotten. A teacher can only *remind*. The eight powers are not external prizes; they are latent capacities of the human mind, and the paradoxes are simply the places where we have forgotten them. When you notice yourself in Harry's hindsight or Divya's FOMO, you are not seeing a defect. You are seeing a forgotten power asking to be remembered.

Analogy: The Seed in the Cupboard

Imagine finding, in the back of a cupboard, a packet of seeds you had forgotten. You did not buy them today. They have been waiting. The only question is whether you will plant them, water them and wait. The eight siddhis are those seeds. The paradoxes are the weeds that grow where nothing was planted.

The Nine Treasures

The verse pairs the eight siddhis with the *nav nidhi*, the nine treasures of the tradition. Counting them precisely belongs to scholars; what matters for this book is the pairing itself. The siddhis are capacities; the treasures are what those capacities help a life to hold: wealth that is honestly earned, but also knowledge, health, relationships and peace. A trader who gains rupees at the price of his health and his family has collected one treasure and spent eight.

> **A QUESTION TO CARRY**
>
> If I could keep only the powers, and lose every rupee I have ever made, would I still be a wealthy person? And if I kept the rupees and lost the powers, would I stay wealthy for long?

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 24

- The siddhis were given in service, and Hanuman became a giver.
- The highest use of power is to pass it on: teach one person.
- The powers are forgotten, not absent; the paradoxes are the weeds where nothing was planted.
- The treasures are what the powers help a life hold: wealth, but also health, knowledge, relationships and peace.

CHAPTER 25

Building the Daily Practice

A year in eight seasons

The Main Idea

Trying to acquire all eight powers at once is like trying to learn eight instruments in a week. The sages spoke of lifetimes, not weeks. The plan in this chapter spreads the work over one year, in eight seasons of roughly six weeks each, with a paradox or two attached to each season so that theory is always tested against a real problem.

The Rhythm of Every Season

- **Weeks 1-2:** Read the power's chapter again. Begin the smallest daily rep.
- **Weeks 3-4:** Read the paired paradox chapter. Add the paradox's daily rep.
- **Weeks 5-6:** Keep both reps, and review: what changed? What did the evening review say?

The Eight Seasons

Season	Power in focus	Paradox(es) practised	The one daily rep
1	Anima	Winner's Curse (14), Hindsight (13)	Ask before telling; write predictions before the fact
2	Garima	Tortoise and Hare (19)	Three non-negotiables; the one-breath delay

Season	Power in focus	Paradox(es) practised	The one daily rep
3	Laghima	Clutter Curse (20)	The weekly release; *Done. Next.*
4	Mahima	Screen Time (17), Scaling by Volume (21)	Ten-year sentence; the hourly distance walk
5	Prapti	FOMO (16)	One ask a day; the missed list
6	Prakamya	Employee Mindset (15)	Weekly design hour; one if-then sentence
7	Ishitva	Emotional Entry (18)	Name it; the long exhale; the cooling rule
8	Vashitva	Boredom Tax (22), Dollar Sign Delusion (23)	The habit audit; the two-column ledger

Analogy: The Gym with Eight Machines

A well-designed gym trains each major muscle group on its own day. Nobody expects to work chest, legs, back and shoulders to exhaustion in one session. The eight siddhis are eight machines. Season by season you work each one, and by the end of the year, none of the muscles is a stranger.

The Three Daily Anchors

Whatever the season, keep three anchors every day, each no more than ten minutes:

1. **Morning intention (3 minutes).** Read your non-negotiables and your ten-year sentence, and name the season's power.

2. **One rep during the day (the smallest possible).** The rep for your current season.
3. **Evening review (5 minutes).** The eight-line review from Chapter 3, with an extra line for today's paradox: *where did it visit me?*

The Weekly and Monthly Check

- **Weekly:** Read the week's evening reviews as a set. Note the one instrument that keeps showing up red.
- **Monthly:** Re-read one chapter from a power that is *not* in this season. A neglected instrument slips quietly.
- **Every season's end:** Teach one person one thing you learned. Giving is the second half of getting.

When You Fall Off

You will. The day you miss is not a failure; it is data. Restart with the smallest rep. The tortoise did not apologise to the hare for walking slowly; he simply kept walking.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 25

- Spread the work over eight seasons of about six weeks each.
- Pair every power with one or two paradoxes so theory meets a live problem.
- Keep three daily anchors: morning intention, one rep, evening review.
- Review weekly, revisit a neglected power monthly, and teach someone each season.
- A missed day is data; restart with the smallest rep.

CHAPTER 26

The Traps: How Each Power Turns Into Its Shadow

Counterfeits, and how to spot them

The Main Idea

Patanjali warned that the powers can become obstacles if the practitioner becomes attached to them. Every power in this book has a counterfeit: a look-alike that feels like the real thing and does the opposite of its work. This chapter gathers them in one place so you can run a quick check on yourself.

The Eight Counterfeits

Power	The real thing	The counterfeit	The check question
Anima	Chosen smallness	Self-erasure, hiding	Am I small on purpose, and will I return to full size?
Mahima	Wide lens, courage	Arrogance, overreach	Does my vastness humble me or inflate me?
Garima	Mass of character	Stubbornness	Am I immovable for a value, or for my pride?
Laghima	Letting go	Flakiness, drifting	Am I light with roots, or merely blown about?
Prapti	Prepared reach	Greed, grasping	Is my hand open after it receives?
Prakamya	Free, grounded will	Fantasy	What is the smallest thing I will do about it by tomorrow?

Power	The real thing	The counterfeit	The check question
Ishitva	Command with fluency	Suppression	Can I feel it fully and still choose?
Vashitva	Self-governance	Control of others	Am I steering myself, or trying to steer them?

The Three Master Traps

Beyond the eight counterfeits, three traps threaten the whole project:

1. **Spiritual vanity.** Using these ideas to feel superior to other traders and to people generally. The moment you begin to teach as a judge instead of a fellow student, Anima has left the room.
2. **Collecting instead of practising.** Reading book after book, listening to chapter after chapter, and never doing the daily rep. Knowledge that is not practised is clutter (Chapter 20).
3. **Using the powers to chase rupees.** If you practise these capacities *only* to make more money, you will be back in the Dollar Sign Delusion (Chapter 23). Let the rupees be a by-product, as the siddhis themselves are in the tradition.

Analogy: The Fake Gold

A jeweller learns to recognise gold not only by looking at gold but by studying every metal that imitates it. In the same way, you will recognise the powers by their weight in your hand, and their counterfeits by their hollow ring. Ask: does this make me *freer and kinder*, or merely *bigger and louder*?

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 26

- Every power has a counterfeit; learn the counterfeit as carefully as the power.
- Use the eight check questions when you suspect you have slipped.
- Beware three master traps: spiritual vanity, collecting without practising, and chasing rupees.
- The test of the real thing: it makes you freer and kinder.

CHAPTER 27

The Eight as One

Hanuman as a complete human being

The Main Idea

We have walked eight powers and eleven paradoxes. We end by putting the eight back into one figure, because the eight were never separate. A complete human being is not a person who maximises one dial. He is a person who can move each dial to the right place at the right moment, and who knows, without effort, which one to touch.

Hanuman at the Shore

Return to the shore of the southern ocean. Jambavan speaks. In a single sequence, the eight work as one. Hanuman remembers (the lifting of the curse of forgetfulness), he grows (Mahima), he plants his feet (Garima), he leaps (Laghima and Prapti), he refuses the offered rest (Vashitva), he outwits the sea-demoness by shrinking (Anima), he takes the form each situation needs (Prakamya), and he does all of it without being ruled by pride or fear (Ishitva). The siddhis are not eight tools; they are one skilled human being, seen from eight angles.

Analogy: The Orchestra

Think of an orchestra. Strings, brass, woodwind, percussion: each section has a distinct voice. A composer who writes only for the brass produces noise. A conductor who can bring the strings in softly, the brass in at the climax, the percussion at the right beat and silence at the right second produces music. The eight powers are the sections of the orchestra of the self. Vashitva is

the conductor. Without the conductor the sections play at once; with him, they play in turn.

The Trader as a Complete Person

A complete trader, by this reading, is not the one with the cleverest idea. He is the one who is small when he is corrected and large when the long picture matters; heavy in his rules and light about last week's loss; reaching in his learning and clear in his choices; in command of his fear and greed, and in charge of his own house. Such a person will meet all eleven paradoxes. He will not avoid them. He will simply recognise them, one by one, as old acquaintances, and walk through.

A Closing Practice: The Eight Bows

Once a week, take five minutes and make eight silent bows, each with one sentence:

1. *Anima:* I do not know everything, and that is my doorway.
2. *Mahima:* This day is one frame in a long film.
3. *Garima:* I will keep what I have promised.
4. *Laghima:* I put down what I do not need.
5. *Prapti:* I will ask, and prepare, and receive.
6. *Prakamya:* I choose who I am today.
7. *Ishitva:* I feel the force, and I decide what to do with it.
8. *Vashitva:* I govern my own house.

The Last Word

A river does not argue with the shape of the land. It learns the shape and flows. Hanuman's eight powers are not weapons against the world. They are the shapes a fully attentive human

being learns to take in order to flow through it with grace. May you be small when it is wise, vast when it is needed, heavy when you must stand, light when you must go, reaching without grasping, free without fantasy, commanding without cruelty, and, above all, the ruler of your own quiet house. And when the power comes, as it will in small ways, may you remember what the verse said: it was given, and you were meant to give it on.

Main Stressing Points of Chapter 27

- The eight powers are one human being seen from eight angles.
- Vashitva is the conductor; the other seven are the sections of the orchestra.
- The complete trader is the complete person: balanced, not extreme.
- The paradoxes will come; recognise them like old acquaintances.
- Practise the eight bows weekly; give what you receive.

CLOSING PAGES

A Reader's Review Sheet

Two minutes per power, five for the paradoxes

The Eight Powers on One Page

Power	Telugu	Meaning	Daily rep
Anima	□□□□	Voluntary smallness	Ask before telling; one anonymous act
Mahima	□□□□	Voluntary expansion	View from above; ten-year sentence
Garima	□□□□	Voluntary heaviness	Three non-negotiables; one-breath delay
Laghima	□□□□	Voluntary lightness	Weekly release; *Done. Next.*
Prapti	□□□□□□□□	Reach and access	One ask a day; build the rope
Prakamya	□□□□□□□□□	Free will and imagination	Design hour; if-then sentence
Ishitva	□□□□□□	Command over inner forces	Name it; long exhale; cooling rule
Vashitva	□□□□□□	Self-governance	Habit audit; *Did I decide this?*

The Eleven Paradoxes on One Page

Paradox	The line to remember	The antidote
Harry Hindsight	Write before the fact	Prakamya, Anima
The Winner's Curse	A win is information, not a verdict	Anima, Garima

Paradox	The line to remember	The antidote
The Employee Mindset	The market owes you no salary	Vashitva, Prakamya
FOMO	There is always another bus	Prapti, Laghima
Screen Time Paradox	Step back to see	Mahima, Vashitva
Emotional Entry	Is this a decision or a feeling?	Ishitva, Garima
Tortoise and the Hare	Choose a pace for ten years	Garima, Anima
The Clutter Curse	Subtract one thing a week	Laghima, Anima
Scaling by Volume	Every extra trade is a bill	Anima, Mahima
The Boredom Tax	Plan your quiet	Vashitva, Garima
Dollar Sign Delusion	Rupees measure results, not you	All eight

Ten Questions for Your Evening

1. Where was I too large today, and where too small?
2. What did I carry that I did not need?
3. Where did I move when I should have stayed?
4. What did I ask for, or fail to ask for?
5. Did I choose my day, or did it happen to me?
6. Which force visited me, and what did I do with it?
7. How many autopilot moments did I count?
8. Which paradox came to my door today?
9. What did I score in conduct, apart from rupees?
10. What one thing will I teach someone this week?

A Reader's Pledge

> **THE PLEDGE**
>
> I will practise the smallest rep, every day, for a year.
>
> I will judge my days by conduct before rupees.
>
> I will remember that what I have was given, and that I am meant to give it on.

A Last Reminder

This book has contained no strategy and no recommendation to buy or sell anything. Trading carries a real risk of loss, and nothing in these pages is financial advice. Use the ideas as training for the mind, and make every financial decision with your own judgement, your own research, and, where appropriate, a qualified adviser.

About the Author

NerdyIntruder is a discretionary trader and quantitative developer who trades Indian equity and derivatives markets and global crypto options, and writes on trading psychology under the *Nerdy Trading Way* name. This book is his attempt to join an old map of the inner life to the modern problem of staying calm while money moves.

— Om Tat Sat —